

A map of Brooklyn, New York, showing its various community districts. The map is rendered in shades of gray, with the district boundaries clearly outlined. One district, located in the central-eastern part of the borough, is highlighted in a bright yellow color. This highlighted district is District 14, which includes areas like the East Williamsburg and Green-Williamsburg neighborhoods. The map also shows the surrounding water bodies and the Manhattan skyline to the west.

Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests

Fiscal Year
2027

**Brooklyn Community
District
14**

*Prepared by the Community Board
December 2025*

NYC OpenData, New Jersey Office of GIS, Esri, TomTom, Garmin, SafeGraph,
METI/NASA, USGS, EPA, NPS, USDA, USFWS

INTRODUCTION

The annual Statements of Community District Needs (CD Needs Statements) and Community Board Budget Requests (Budget Requests) are Charter mandates that form an integral part of the City's budget process. Together, they are intended to support communities in their ongoing consultations with city agencies, elected officials and other key stakeholders and influence more informed decision making on a broad range of local planning and budget priorities. This report also provides a valuable public resource for neighborhood planning and research purposes, and may be used by a variety of audiences seeking information about New York City's diverse communities.

HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

This report represents the Statement of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests for Fiscal Year (FY) 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board, collected through an online form available to community boards from June to November, 2025.

Community boards may provide substantive supplemental information together with their Statements and Budget Requests. This supporting material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting them into a web browser, such as Chrome, Safari or Firefox.

If you have questions about this report or suggestions for changes please contact:
CDNEEDS_DL@planning.nyc.gov

This report is broadly structured as follows:

1. **Overarching Community District Needs**

Sections 1 – 4 provide an overview of the community district and the top three pressing issues affecting this district overall as identified by the community board. Any narrative provided by the board supporting their selection of their top three pressing issues is included.

2. **Policy Area-Specific District Needs**

Section 5 is organized by seven distinct policy areas aligned with the service and program areas of city agencies. For each policy area, community boards selected the most important issue for their districts and could provide a supporting narrative. The policy area section also includes any agency-specific needs and a list of relevant budget requests submitted by the community board. If the community board submitted additional information outside of a specific policy area, it may be found in Section 6.

3. **Community Board Budget Requests**

The final section includes the two types of budget requests submitted to the City for the FY24 budget cycle; one list for capital and another for expense budget requests. For each budget request, community boards were able to provide a priority number, explanation, location, and supporters. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests submitted to city agencies.

Disclaimer

This report represents the Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests of this Community District for Fiscal Year 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board.

Budget Requests: Listed for informational purposes only. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests and budget request responses.

Budget Priorities: Priority numbers apply to expense and capital Budget requests from all policy areas. A complete list of expense and capital budget requests by this Board sorted by priority can be found in Section 7 of this document.

Supporting Materials: Some community boards provided substantive supplemental information. This supportive material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting the links provided in the Appendix into a browser.

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1. COMMUNITY BOARD INFORMATION

Brooklyn Community Board 14

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Email: scampbell@cb14brooklyn.com

Website: cb14brooklyn.com

Chair: Karl-Henry Cesar

District Manager: Shawn Alyse Campbell

2. 2020 CENSUS DATA

The following two pages contain data from the most recent 2020 Decennial Census, which includes basic demographic and housing characteristics for New York City, the borough, and this community district. The data also includes a view of change over time since 2010.

New York City

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	8,175,133	100.00	8,804,190	100.00	629,057	7.7	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	1,768,111	21.6	1,740,142	19.8	-27,969	-1.6	-1.8
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	8,175,133	100.0	8,804,190	100.0	629,057	7.7	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	2,336,076	28.6	2,490,350	28.3	154,274	6.6	-0.3
White non-Hispanic	2,722,904	33.3	2,719,856	30.9	-3,048	-0.1	-2.4
Black non-Hispanic	1,861,295	22.8	1,776,891	20.2	-84,404	-4.5	-2.6
Asian non-Hispanic	1,028,119	12.6	1,373,502	15.6	345,383	33.6	3.0
Some other race, non-Hispanic	78,063	1.0	143,632	1.6	65,569	84.0	0.6
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	148,676	1.8	299,959	3.4	151,283	101.8	1.6
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	3,371,062	100.0	3,618,635	100.0	247,573	7.3	0.0
Occupied housing units	3,109,784	92.2	3,370,448	93.1	260,664	8.4	0.9
Vacant housing units	261,278	7.8	248,187	6.9	-13,091	-5.0	-0.9

Brooklyn

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	2,504,700	100.00	2,736,074	100.00	231,374	9.2	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	594,378	23.7	595,703	21.8	1,325	0.2	-1.9
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	2,504,700	100.0	2,736,074	100.0	231,374	9.2	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	496,285	19.8	516,426	18.9	20,141	4.1	-0.9
White non-Hispanic	893,306	35.7	968,427	35.4	75,121	8.4	-0.3
Black non-Hispanic	799,066	31.9	729,696	26.7	-69,370	-8.7	-5.2
Asian non-Hispanic	260,129	10.4	370,776	13.6	110,647	42.5	3.2
Some other race, non-Hispanic	15,904	0.6	37,579	1.4	21,675	136.3	0.8
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	40,010	1.6	113,170	4.1	73,160	182.9	2.5
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	1,000,293	100.0	1,077,654	100.0	77,361	7.7	0.0
Occupied housing units	916,856	91.7	1,009,804	93.7	92,948	10.1	2.0
Vacant housing units	83,437	8.3	67,850	6.3	-15,587	-18.7	-2.0

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

Brooklyn Community District 14

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	160,664	100.00	164,568	100.00	3,904	2.4	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	40,031	24.9	36,180	22	-3,851	-9.6	-2.9
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	160,664	100.0	164,568	100.0	3,904	2.4	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	25,165	15.7	24,726	15.0	-439	-1.7	-0.7
White non-Hispanic	59,590	37.1	61,736	37.5	2,146	3.6	0.4
Black non-Hispanic	56,948	35.4	46,445	28.2	-10,503	-18.4	-7.2
Asian non-Hispanic	15,147	9.4	21,317	13.0	6,170	40.7	3.6
Some other race, non-Hispanic	1,131	0.7	2,332	1.4	1,201	106.2	0.7
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	2,683	1.7	8,012	4.9	5,329	198.6	3.2
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	60,417	100.0	62,254	100.0	1,837	3.0	0.0
Occupied housing units	56,852	94.1	59,355	95.3	2,503	4.4	1.2
Vacant housing units	3,565	5.9	2,899	4.7	-666	-18.7	-1.2

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

Statement on Data Accuracy

Under Title 13 of the U.S. Code, the Census Bureau is legally bound to protect the privacy of individuals participating in the decennial census. To adhere to the law and to avoid the disclosure of information about individual respondents, the Census Bureau has historically applied a host of techniques, such as top- and bottom-coding, imputation, table- and cell-suppression, and data swapping. The Census Bureau is employing a new technique with the 2020 Census, referred to as the Disclosure Avoidance System (DAS), based on differential privacy. With this approach, the Census Bureau “infuses noise” systematically across census data and sets a quantified disclosure risk, referred to as the Privacy Loss Budget (PLB).

While the new DAS approach may diminish the risk of disclosure concerns, it comes at a cost to data accuracy. Consequently, 2020 Census data users should be aware that all sub-state counts, except for housing units (which are unaffected by the DAS), may be adjusted to protect the privacy of Census participants and may be subject to reduced accuracy. Because DAS noise infusion is randomized, it is impossible for data users to know the degree to which any individual statistic is altered. However, it is possible to say that in general the relative size of errors decreases as counts increase. Consequently, data users should have greater confidence in the accuracy of the data as counts get larger. Further, an evaluation of a Privacy-Protected Microdata File (PPMF), treated with a Disclosure Avoidance System like the one applied to 2020 redistricting data, showed that counts of 300 or more rarely have sizable errors (error beyond +/- 10% of the count). Therefore, while data users need to be cognizant of data accuracy limitations, they should have confidence in conclusions based on sizable counts, which are relatively unaffected by the Census Bureau’s latest disclosure avoidance method.

3. OVERVIEW OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT

There have been very few changes since the FY 26 Community Needs and Budget Priorities were submitted, other than all needs becoming more urgent. The ability to reflect the district and express needs and budget priorities is hampered by a poorly designed platform, poor coordination between OMB, DCP and the responding agencies and a lack of meaningful support for the community boards that strive every year to make this process useful for boards and community members.

4. TOP THREE PRESSING ISSUES OVERALL

Brooklyn Community Board 14

The three most pressing issues facing this Community Board are:

Other - Write In (Required)

Because there are so many issues, various needs and many demographic, socio-economic and policy shifts everything is a number one priority for someone. It is important that all city agencies have the capacity to serve the public and it is imperative that the city coordinate internally and across departments to meet community needs. Currently this is not happening in NYC.

###

Community Boards have not had a significant budget increase in 20 years and headcount has remained the same since our inception. Yet, CBs were tasked with gathering local input on complex zoning text changes, to continue weighing in on ULURP applications, expanding permits applications for cannabis retail, open dining and more. Additional responsibilities have been heaped on District Managers including functioning as agency privacy officers, conducting hybrid meetings, providing language access with little to no outside support and increasingly working with new board members who receive little training, or onboarding support.

###

Meaningful local consultation has fallen off a cliff. Last year, the Department of City Planning passed three zoning text amendments but would not provide district level environmental impact statements and could not speak to how the various elements of these complex proposals will interact at the local level. CB14 recently garnered a Planning Fellow who will help discern this for our district. To the extent that capacity, accessibility, equity and resiliency improvements are being made by agencies and utilities alike, there is insufficient coordination and communication so that roadway disruptions are extended and use of the public right of way and public space in general is poorly planned.

###

Affordable housing and housing security are urgent concerns. There are 800 housing violations per 1000 units in CD14, Getting information from the Department of Homeless Services regarding shelters in the district is nearly impossible. Now there is an investigation into whether shelter contracting followed proper procedure. We are told only days in advance, when we are told at all that a shelter is opening or changing population. It takes street outreach teams hundreds of interactions with unsheltered individuals to convince them to accept services. It's time for a paradigm shift. The City keeps funding approaches that do not work.

###

Every year for over a decade we have had to request for the restoration of some baseline DSNY service or another. The Department of Sanitation defunded Manual Litter Patrol (MLP) – a baseline service, while simultaneously increasing enforcement on the very community they are supposed to serve. DSNY suggests we ask city councilmembers to fund "cleaning". In a district with five overlapping city councilmembers, this means that MLP is not provided equally throughout the district. Furthermore, every time we move a dollar from one account to another within the city, it loses value. The loss of efficiency is equivalent to the loss in service. Baseline services should be

paid directly through DSNY's own budget so that the services are provided equally throughout the district. This way additional council grants can support special projects, such as graffiti removal, catch basin clearing or tree pit maintenance, rather than supplanting DSNY's core mission.

###

The department is offloading the cost of public waste containers onto Business Improvement Districts (BIDs) while simultaneously failing to provide vendor enforcement in those same BIDS. The city imposed a monopoly by requiring NYC residents to buy a single sourced garbage can. DSNY has threatened to punish small businesses who have not contracted with a new private carting company by forcing them into a contract with the most expensive option. There is legislation pending at the State level to address DSNY's culturally insensitive enforcement on residential collection rules in religious communities.

###

Flooding continues to be a concern in the district. Infrastructure resiliency includes street conditions/roadway, street bridge, mass transit maintenance and infrastructure; street flooding; maintenance and cleanliness of institutions, natural assets, and public space. There are five chronic flooding locations in the district that flood every time it rains more than 1.5 inches an hour. Yet, there are no city-based solutions. The Comptroller's office paid \$4,826,552 in sewer overflow claims from (2017-2021). There are numerous emergency sewer line repairs in the district. Yet, DCP did not consider local environmental impacts in any of the COY proposals. These facts underscore the need for proactive upgrades and interagency coordination.

###

DOT has one of the most expansive portfolios in the city. Their ability to coordinate within the department is often obviously challenged. Coordination across city agencies is worse. Community engagement is poor, misguided and disingenuous. Trench repair requests continue to languish. DOT continues to add asphalt to sinking streets and will not repair trenches unless they are part of a total street reconstruction. Three road bridges in CD14 are scheduled for repair but the full scope has not been determined. The purview issues surrounding Newkirk Plaza disqualify the Newkirk Street bridge from a component contract and likely put the timing of repairs beyond the horizon. DOT installs traffic calming devices with only spotty dialog with emergency responders and no maintenance plan. DOT has allowed Citibike to install docks that force people to step into the Caton Avenue truck route to dock the bike even though the sidewalk along the Parade Ground is extra wide. The revenue that the city collects for the public bike share program was a mere \$1.4 million in 2023 which is likely a very small share but we don't know for sure because the department was not able to provide what Lyft makes on the project. For-profit uses of the public street space including bike docking stations, reserved ride share parking and electrical vehicle charging stations, Amazon loading zones and sidewalk lockers, compete with public uses such as bike lanes, bus lanes, parking meters and even walkable sidewalks. DOT cannot explain how these competing interests are prioritized. It is difficult to have confidence in expanding programs under DOT's watch when the agency has not responded to repair requests, has not maintained other assets, and has not improved the time it takes to respond to speed hump requests (typically more than 3 years) or stop sign studies.

Other - Write In (Required)

Several of CB14 priorities have lingered on this list for years and even decades without being addressed or in some cases meaningfully acknowledged by the relevant agencies, including the establishment of a pedestrian plaza at Newkirk Plaza, open space expansion, and relocation of the 70th police precinct house. CB14 has advocated for Newkirk Plaza to be activated as a public plaza since DOT began the pedestrian plaza program, still to no avail. We have been told that a resolution is "imminent" for the past 10 months; defying the definition of imminent. Conditions on the Plaza

are in a downward spiral even though the plaza is already a plaza. DOT is willing to adopt the plaza into its program. MTA has indicated a willingness to sign agreements for plaza use, but has displayed foot dragging that makes buses look fast. It has taken them months so far to conduct a necessary engineering study. In the meantime, the Flatbush Development Corp wants to serve as the community partner. FDC has secured funding to improve and beautify the plaza. Recently MTA rejected their proposal to add a mural to the station house because MTA policy requires that station houses need to be identified as such. It seems from this that graffiti, dirt and urine stains make a station house more identifiable than a mural. The lack of agency accountability for the plaza must end and the only thing in the way of adoption into the DOT Pedestrian Plaza program is MTA inaction. Yet, they are excited about bringing the IBX and all the new stations that service will require to the District. It seems reasonable to expect MTA to maintain current assets if they expect hyper-local support for new ones.

Community Board 14 has the highest percentage citywide of residents who live more than a quarter mile away from a park. This is more than an issue of recreation - it has serious public health ramifications. Health disparities are exacerbated by the lack of outdoor recreational amenities. The Department of Parks and Recreation does not have an independent capital budget that can be objectively applied to parks in need of rehabilitation. Instead they rely on Councilmember funding. Here are three problems with this: 1. Councilmember term limits are such that most park rehabilitations won't be complete until the member has termed out; 2. CB14 has five overlapping CMs who represent more of the boarding district and thus have the (voter) incentive to fund outside of CD14; 3. capital funding for parks is not driven by objective criteria but by the vagaries of council district representation. This means that some playgrounds could get multiple refurbishments before others get one. That doesn't make sense. It is not equitable. It is not efficient. DPR should have its own independent capital budget to maintain the assets in its portfolio.

The African burial ground at Bedford Avenue and Church Avenue was transferred to the Department of Parks and Recreation in 2022 to develop an important memorial. It has completed the Public Design Commission presentation and adjusted the plan accordingly. Parks, working with the local council representative, included community input with focus on the descendant community. CB14 will maintain this priority though the continued support option in our budget requests. The community is looking forward to the installation of the Shirley Chisholm memorial sculpture and welcome center at the Parkside entrance to Prospect Park. CB14 has requested that Umma Park and the Campus Road Tot Lot be fully rehabilitated. We are grateful that there has been a councilmanic allocation for Umma Park from Councilmember Rita Joseph. Still, we believe that DPR should have agency over their own capital budget so they do not rely solely on council allocations. This would ensure that parks are rehabilitated according to objective measures of need.

The 70th Police Precinct must balance responding to crime, gang activity, quality of life complaints, and community relations in a racially, ethnically, religiously, and socio-economically diverse community. They do so from a precinct house that is located as far away from the heart of the district as can be. OMB approved a site search for a new precinct house three years ago but only three locations have been reviewed (and all rejected). This is a request that has been acknowledged, agreed upon, yet has been pending for over 30 years. Yet, this year at budget consultations NYPD representatives literally shrugged when asked about the status of their efforts. It is clear that leadership at NYPD is not advocating for the conditions of MOS at the precinct level. In the meantime, the current 70th precinct house is in constant disrepair. It leaks and floods and must depend on volunteer community members for maintenance.

Capacity to tow vehicles relies on headcount and tow vehicles, all of which are under resourced. NYPD cannot fill school crossing guard jobs. Headcount at the precinct is so low that it is impossible to tell if the Q-Team approach is working because Q-Team officers are constantly on patrol.

Other - Write In (Required)

We receive more service delivery requests for issues related to DOT than any other agency. Community members generate requests for traffic studies; street conditions; for traffic calming such as speed humps, stop signs, traffic signals; changes in alternate side of the street parking; sidewalk conditions; bike lanes that make sense and more. In addition, DOT has initiated installations of pedestrian islands; curb extensions; bike lane expansions; Amazon loading zones and sidewalk lockers, and more. The requests and initiatives too often do not intersect. DOT claims of community engagement are not broad enough, and rely too heavily on self-selected data gathered in their portals. It is not the average resident who takes the time to find input portals on DOT's labyrinth website to drop a pin where they'd like to see a bike lane or a residential loading zone. This is highly self selected data and it has its uses, but proof of community engagement is not one of them.

With so many projects and requests and with the increased development in the area, CB14 continues to encourage DOT to implement changes based on data and studies of the specifics of the areas that will be affected by projects and to include the community in the early phases of proposal development. Such projects need to be carefully coordinated other agencies. We should not have to hear from FDNY that pedestrian islands, speed humps or bike lanes will impede their emergency response times. Their input must be woven into the development of a proposal, not as remarks on a final proposal. That is inefficient and could cost lives. Private entities that are making money off of the use of taxpayer supported public space should be responsible to maintaining, and cleaning those spaces and consideration for additional service should be sewn into their contracts. DOT could be much better coordinated with SBS so that bus lane installations, delivery windows, and Citibike stations support economic development.

5. SUMMARY OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT NEEDS AND BUDGET REQUESTS

HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Healthcare and Human Services

Other - Write In (Required)

Health care and human service needs are intertwined. Services for low income and vulnerable adults, for seniors and those who are homebound overlap with disease prevention and mental health services. Substandard housing has a substantial impact on health and mental health. Once an individual has become homeless, a whole host of services have not been made available or have failed. Prevention is the best care. In a community-wide survey, affordable housing and programs for unsheltered homeless individuals ranked the highest and prevention programs ranked second. For those who are housed, CB 14 continues to rank high in severe housing overcrowding. More than 28% of our tenants are severely rent burdened (paying more than 50% of their income on rent) about the same as in 2010 when it was 29%. About 42% of low income residents are severely rent burdened, down slightly from 44% in 2010. The district ranks alarmingly high citywide in the growing number of housing code violations per 1000 units of housing: 506 in 2010, 667 in 2019 and 879 in 2024. Of these 280/1000 are serious housing code violations, up from 109/100 in 2010. The idea that they city is easing the way for more development while letting current housing stock dilapidate into moldy fire hazards is incomprehensible.

In 2010, 98% of recently added housing units were affordable at 80% AMI, in 2023 it was down slightly to 97%. The percentage at 30% of AMI has increased slightly in the same timeframe from 4.9 to 6.2%. However, 25% of CD14 households make 30% AMI. CD14 added 2600 units of housing from 2010-2020 - more than anticipated by COY. It's notable that this additional housing was developed while the population decreased.

As for the unhoused, It is exceedingly difficult to move a person off the street once they have become homeless. Therefore, prevention is of paramount importance. The high rate of overcrowding, the number of rent burdened households and the horrible numbers on housing code violations exacerbate housing vulnerability in our district in ways that will not be addressed by any of the COY zoning text amendments. There are approximately 120,000 individuals crowded into an expansion of NYC shelter beds. Increasingly, thousands of people sleep on the streets every night. Street outreach is not robust enough to convince individuals to accept services. The services clearly are not meeting enough needs. Approximately 145,000 students are experiencing homelessness in 2024. This number has soared from one in eight to one in five school children.

The city has failed to inform local stakeholders of new shelter sites, and has failed to coordinate with CBOs to serve those sites and has failed to manage those service contracts. There are now three DHS shelters in CD14. The first two were at least subject of a public presentation. The third one, a mens shelter in a former emergency family shelter was announced by a phone call from a DSS representative to the District Manager just days before the opening.

Contracting for shelters in CD 14 has been a bewildering process. The lack of transparency is well-documented and the Community Advisory Boards (CABs) meet rarely and have not been accountable when it comes to addressing issues raised. Black Vets for Social Justice operates in a men's shelter on Duryea Place, practically on the loading dock of Kings Theater and next door to a supportive housing facility for people experiencing mental illness. From its opening on May 5, 2023 to October 24, 2023 when the Black Vets for Social Justice held its first CAB meeting, there were

263 911 calls to the shelter. In addition, residents have called 311 related to the shelter and its residents. Program and security capacity must be increased. The women's shelter on Kenilworth Place has not had a CAB meeting in over two years. This is supposed to be a contractual obligation. The hotel shelter on Coney Island Avenue had People's Path in place on paper for over a year and a half before anyone from that organization showed up at the shelter. They are now converting it into a men's shelter with no publicly facing process.

Community District Needs Related to Healthcare and Human Services

Needs for Health Care and Facilities

Health: Of note is the aging of CD14's population. In 2010 those age 65 and better was 9.8%; by 2022 it rose to 15.4%. It is projected that the aging population will continue to increase as a share. New Yorkers over 60 years old are diverse and nearly 50% speak a first language other than English. They are more likely to live below the poverty line. In CD14, this applies to 16.2% of those over 65. The provision of community services, such as senior centers and library programs; social services and direct services depend on being intertwined.

It is heartening that DFTA is ahead of the curve on recognizing the importance of interagency coordination. Through the NYC Cabinet for Older New Yorkers, all city policies can be viewed through the perspective of older community members to ensure that new agency proposals are age-inclusive.

Maimonides Community Hospital has applied for a zoning map change that will allow the addition of an infectious disease intake center. CB14 approved their application. We are disheartened that other city agencies such as DOT and NYPD has fallen short on assisting the hospital and surrounding community with parking and traffic issues and will continue to urge better cooperation and more action.

Needs for Older NYs

According to the Department for the Aging's analysis of Census data, the population of older New Yorkers is increasing as a share of the total population. In 2023, NYC had 1.43 million over 65 which is a 53% increase from 2000. The aging population is increasingly diverse. The majority are people of color. The population of those over the age of 85 is increasing the most, but "younger" older New Yorkers seeking services is on the rise. From 2010-2021, the poverty rate in CD14 dropped from 22-17%. For those age 65 and older it dropped a bit less, from 26-22%, remaining higher than the full population. These shifts require new focus on providing support services for aging New Yorkers. Housing, food access, healthcare and transportation all have to be coordinated to address the needs of our aging population. The number of senior centers in the district remains flat and there has been only one housing development for seniors in 2020 when Church of the Redeemer leadership built an as-of-right, 88 studio unit building for seniors and women aging out of foster care.

Needs for Homeless

The Human Resource Administration/Department of Social Services/Department of Homeless Services, is an agency with scores of programs to prevent homelessness, run homeless shelters and provide street outreach to unsheltered individuals. In part, due to the steep increase in the homeless census due to migration and in part, due to the city's capacity and coordination challenges, those living on the streets is at an all time high. The number and percentage of homeless students is also at an all time high. This represents a current crises and a future of trauma-based needs.

A paradigm shift that scales up some of the more effective programs that seem to be making a difference is acutely needed. The SHAP program, headed by Norman Seigel and a group of volunteer trusted messengers seem to be making impressive progress on street outreach efforts. How can the city scale up successes and divert from failing contracts?

Needs for Low Income NYs

In an attempt to assess agency capacity and coordination needs, Community Board 14 continues to host non-profit roundtable events each year to stay aware of the needs being met by Community Based Organizations (CBO), who they are serving, and what type of support they need to manage and expand caseloads. In the past we brought the CBOs together with city agencies and nonprofit support organizations to expand their capacity and strengthen the CBO network in our community. Reimbursement contracts continue to be a strain on nonprofits. Given how many city services are provided through contracting, supporting this element of our community is critical. In 2024 CB14 organized a health issues lunch and learn series. We continue to expand ways to reach our community members with important information, access to programs and opportunities to be involved. However, given that CB14's own budget has not increased in over 20 years, it is becoming increasingly challenging to organize special events.

HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DFTA	1 / 2	Increase staffing for homebound adult programs
DFTA	2 / 2	Funding for a new senior center program
DHS	1 / 2	Improve safety at homeless shelters
DHS	2 / 2	Expand street outreach
DOHMH	1 / 4	Create or promote programs to de-stigmatize mental health needs and encourage treatment
DOHMH	2 / 4	Create or promote programs to de-stigmatize substance misuse and encourage treatment
DOHMH	3 / 4	Other programs to address public health issues requests
DOHMH	4 / 4	Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations
HHC	1 / 1	Maternal Health Disparities
HRA	1 / 1	Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing

YOUTH, EDUCATION AND CHILD WELFARE

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

Other - Write In (Required)

Issues related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare are intertwined and it is important to knit services and resources together and break through silos. For the past 17 years CB 14 has organized a Youth Conference, which has attracted over 300 young community members to meet with 80 organizations, agencies and job providers. The need for youth workforce development, youth employment, youth justice, youth homelessness and youth centered cure violence programs are more urgent than ever and we continue to advocate for an even greater expansion of DYCD, and ACS funding and CBO support contracts that are registered and paid on time. Contracting methodology should be reviewed by the city. It seems odd that CB6, which for households with members under the age of 18 has a poverty rate of 5% and receives \$2,9990,908 in DYCD contracts, and our district receives \$2,042481 despite a significantly higher poverty rate of 32% in households with minors. Youth workforce development garnered the most support in the youth section of CB14's community needs survey.

Cure violence programs continue to receive the highest percentage of support in the public safety section of CB14's community survey; underscoring the relationship of services to one another (the community gets it)! This is all the more pressing given that NYPD has been redirected from the robust community engagement of the NCO program in exchange for a data driven Q-Team model. In addition, NYPD's request for budget support was for the Explorers program. It seems that police in the community want to interact with the community but policy from the top is creating barriers.

As for schools, there must be a recognition that income disparities, housing disparities, and the disparities in parental educational attainment, as well as the number of first languages spoken at home, family size and more, make learning challenging in different ways in different households. In NYC one in five school children will have experienced homelessness. In the district there have been some mixed trends in test scores. In 2022 students with proficient scores on the English Language Arts (ELA) test was 37%, in 2023 it fell to 27%. For math the scores went up in the same period from 50% to 59%.

SCA refuses to participate in CB Committee meetings. We used to get a once-a-year 1/2 hour update on capital projects in the district. These served to keep the community informed and saved hours of time reaching out to SCA due to complaints. For years we were considered a district in need of seats but there are very few PS/IS schools over capacity now. We urge DOE and SCA to assess the new class size maximum rules to update the need for elementary school seats. In the meantime, new private schools and charter schools have been opened and require support such as crossing guards. There needs to be an increase in the number of guards assigned to our community and enough incentive to fill headcount.

Community District Needs Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

Needs for Youth Education

There are 35 public elementary and secondary schools in the district which served more than 20,000 students pre-pandemic. In addition, there are more than 26 private/parochial elementary and secondary schools with 6709 students. Our schools have a higher than citywide average of ELL students, which increased as children from migrant families in shelters were added to the rolls. Over 30 different first languages are represented on one of our elementary schools. Given stresses on social services, guidance counseling and technology access concerns, this district is at greater risk of grade level and on time graduation. Services for immigrant youth, afterschool programs and

early childhood development are all rated as a top need on the district's NDA survey. Do our schools have the capacity and are they well-coordinated with CBOs and other youth and family support services to support such diverse needs?

Needs for Youth and Child Welfare

Twenty-five percent of CD14's population is under the age of 17; 34% is under the age of 24. The poverty rate in CD14 has increased from 17% in 2000 to 21% in 2022. Alarming, the poverty rate for households with children under 18 is still 32%. DYCD programs such as Compass and SYEP are in high demand in the district. The expansion of ACS programs for justice involved youth seem to be increasingly utilized by cure violence groups and by the YNCO's from the 70th Precinct. O'hel Children and Family Services was awarded the community's only Family Enrichment Center last year. Support for cure violence programs in the public safety section of CB14's budget priorities survey were the number one priority by far.

YOUTH, EDUCATION AND CHILD WELFARE

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
SCA	1 / 1	Provide a new or expand an existing elementary school

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
ACS	1 / 1	Other foster care and child welfare requests
DYCD	1 / 1	Provide, expand, or enhance the Summer Youth Employment Program

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Public Safety and Emergency Services

Other - Write In (Required)

A new 70th precinct house is still a high priority in the district based in part on the number of decades it has been identified as a priority combined with NYPD's investment without return in recent years. In 2024, John Jay College released results of a NYPD survey. Nearly 25% of NYPD respondents indicated that they intend to leave the job "as soon as feasible" and "dissatisfaction with...the conditions of facilities and equipment" was among the reasons.

The 70th Precinct House is a case study in poor conditions. In 2018, the NYPD Capital Unit conducted a \$1 million feasibility study to determine that the current location is unsuitable. OMB then green-lighted a site search for a new location but to no avail and it is obvious that NYPD has discontinued their efforts. When asked about this item at the FY27 budget consultations, NYPD representatives literally shrugged. It seems that they have given up on supporting precincts. In meantime NYPD is relying on community volunteer efforts to repair the precinct. Leaking and flooding are chronic. Buildings that don't leak from the roofs and flood from the basement, that have heat in the winter, updated technology and closets that are closets instead of offices, should be the minimum expectation for the condition of a precinct house.

As the frequency of weather disasters continues to increase, the need for preparedness and response cannot be overstated. Fire safety and addressing general crime are at the core of a safe community. Yet FDNY response time has increased. The coordination between DOT installations and FDNY has been nearly nonexistent. Speed humps on fire routes, protected bike lanes, and pedestrian islands have impeded response from the Cortelyou Road firehouse. Zoning text amendments that anticipate energy storage as of right, must be coordinated with FDNY capacity to respond to lithium fires.

Public nuisance complaints are on a steep rise in the district. The community outreach aspect of the NCO program was valuable but has been eliminated to make way for Q-Teams, which are not fully operational since headcount is down and Q-team officers are assigned to patrol. It is very important that the community and its police force work together to benefit from shifts in a violence disruption and harm reduction models to deal with how youth crime and recidivism are addressed.

Towing is almost at a standstill. The precinct will post on social media that they towed six or seven cars off the streets from time to time but we get about that many complaints in a day. Traffic complaints and requests for enforcement are also on the rise. However, there is no longer a traffic sergeant at the precinct level. There has been very little impact on speeding vehicles, trucks that travel off of routes, 53' trucks that should not be on city streets, and overnight commercial vehicle parking. NYPD blames a lack of capacity including large tow vehicles and headcount. Capacity must be increased, and coordination must be managed.

The transfer of vendor enforcement from NYPD to DSNY was a bad idea that has failed. As the cannabis enforcement debacle illustrated, when a policy roll-out fails the issues become entrenched, and unpermitted street vending is entrenched. The few recent enforcement efforts in this district ended up in the confiscation of 200 pounds of chicken, summonses, and in one case an arrest. Yet, all these vendors returned because without daily patrol, the infrequent enforcement actions are a cost of doing business. Legitimate street vending must be facilitated by increasing and expediting the permit process. Safe food handling, legal and safe products and balancing the interest of brick-and-mortar merchants must be managed.

Needs for Public Safety

The men and women of the 70th Police Precinct serve our community from a precinct house that is poorly suited to their needs and to the needs of the community. The 70th Precinct House is undersized, antiquated and deteriorated. Adapt Community Network, which serves people with cerebral palsy, and the Joseph Belsky house, which serves low-income mobility impaired residents, share this very narrow, one-way street. Thus, one of the most active precinct houses is in the midst of one of the largest concentrations of multiply handicapped people in the city. Is it agency capacity or a dire lack of coordination that has brought us to this standstill? It is high time that NYPD capital get creative. Why not offer to buy-out Adapt so they can relocate their program space, and the precinct can expand to their space? In the meantime, DOT has not fulfilled commitments to review the one-way direction of Lawrence Avenue, or other possible traffic solutions.

The number of crossing guards has not kept pace with need. CBs across Brooklyn make this same request year after year to no avail. Ensuring that the position offers incentives to attract and retain personnel is a priority. Having enough personnel to fill in when guards call in or take leave is another measure that should be brought into practice.

The shift to a cure violence model is well received by the borough and the precinct. The ACS and DYCD programs that support CBOs that have become trusted messengers in the community must be adequately funded and coordinated with support programs. Bringing funding and program support to the community level and making sure they work in tandem with NYPD's responsibilities is a new challenge that we trust will yield positive results.

Needs for Emergency Services

None of the firehouses in CD 14 are slated for renovations or generators. Given that mandatory inspections are based on Department of Buildings new construction, alteration and demolition permits and given that those permit applications are increasing, the need to ensure adequate resources for inspections is clear. Education programs to prevent fires and swift response are also key. It remains distressing that response times continue to increase for FDNY and for EMS.

The process by which FDNY approves DOT installations such as speed humps, pedestrian islands, and curb extensions is supposed to include local firehouse input. However, it takes more than 30 days for FDNY planning to share DOT plans locally. Furthermore, DOT should be seeking this input in the earliest phase of planning. Instead, DOT fully bakes a plan and then asks FDNY to weigh in on it. As DOT expands street and curb lane use to bike corrals, restaurants, protected bike lanes and more, we must ensure that additional amenities don't conflict with emergency response. The consideration of energy storage as of right, must align with DOB's code development and FDNY's capacity to address unintended consequences.

PUBLIC SAFETY AND EMERGENCY SERVICES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
FDNY	1 / 1	Rehabilitate or renovate existing fire houses or EMS stations
NYPD	1 / 3	Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses
NYPD	2 / 3	Capital investments in Towing capacity
NYPD	3 / 3	Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
FDNY	1 / 2	Provide more firefighters or EMS workers
FDNY	2 / 2	Lifeguard training and management
NYPD	1 / 1	Hire additional crossing guards

CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

Other - Write In (Required)

CD14 has several chronic flooding locations which have been brought to the attention of DEP for years with no amelioration. Extraordinary rain events get a great deal of attention to our hard-hit community, but no action follows. Our chronic locations flood in regular rainstorms. How can we mitigate these regular rain events and how can we better prepare for emergencies? DEP has presented Cloudburst Management and Rainfall Ready programs to CB14's Community Environment Committee. Permeable pavement is being installed in parts of the district. CB14 supports DPR's Lakeshore project. However, these are projects on the horizon.

What can be done in the short term to alleviate the loss of property and closure of businesses when combined sewer systems flood from below while the streets overflow from above? Zoning text amendments that promise flood mitigation were promising but there will be allowances to pave over more backyard space. It's hard to know how this will balance out.. It is imperative that raingarden and other green infrastructure programs be expedited but it is difficult to make request of DEP without knowing where beneath the streets there's too much clay for raingardens, or where permeable pavement can't be installed due to other infrastructure below. We asked DEP to provide us with guidance but have not received a meaningful response.

Sanitation complaints are brought to our attention daily. Every time we bring a matter to the attention of BK14 we get a prompt response. We could not ask for better community partners. Yet, the policy from the top make demand and pace difficult to meet. CD14 also has 54 dead end streets, 2 BIDs and 5 additional commercial streets within our 2.9 square miles, which require specific DSNY services such as MLP. The district is dense with old growth trees, which becomes added work for brooms during leaf season. MLP, which was eliminated, must be fully restored. Instead, DSNY exacerbated the impact of eliminating MLP by also removing the Cleaning Supervisor role. Yet, they will rely on BK14 for commercial waste zone enforcement. That makes no sense.

As of now DSNY tells us to ask our councilmembers to pay for DSNY's responsibilities. The department seems to be increasingly reliant on councilmember funding, which only reaches the parts of the district served by that member. CD14 intersects with five council members so baseline services should come from the baseline budget to ensure that the district is served equitably. DSNY should reinstate community compost sites to complement curbside compost collection.

DSNY is also asking BIDs to pay for containers for public litter and removing public baskets. This will come out of meager BID budgets that are already stretched to supplemental sanitation services instead of DSNY's \$2 billion budget. DSNY will also require that homeowners pay for an official DSNY garbage can by 2026, again, not using their own \$2 billion and providing no exceptions regardless of household income. Vendor enforcement is nonexistent, but tickets issued to homeowners at 7:45 pm and to religious observers on Fridays seem to be on the rise. This is an agency that seems to have a lot of capacity but with so little coordination, it's not serving the taxpayers who fund it to the tune of \$2 billion.

Community District Needs Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

Needs for Water, Sewers, and Environmental Protection

Flooding remains an issue in several locations. Unlike coastal flooding, inland flooding can occur with little to no warning. The cause is impervious pavement, the lack of green space and overwhelmed sewer systems. There have been about a dozen emergency sewer repairs in the district this past year, which demonstrates a worrisome strain on the systems. Ultimately, the overwhelmed system in the city streets is under the purview of DEP and they must address this issue. Bioswales, permeable surfaces, and catch basin and roadway maintenance are interagency concerns. This makes it all the more difficult to coordinate a response.

Trench restoration continues to be an issue in the district. In 2019 DOT was allocated \$60 million to address trench issues citywide, thus DEP was able to pass the ball on these projects. However, not one of the trenches in CD 14 made the DOT list. There has been no progress on this issue. DOT has indicated that it has not begun a single project with the original \$60 million and they will not repair any trenches unless they are a part of a full road reconstruction project. There have been no further allocations, which indicates a complete policy failure.

Needs for Sanitation Services

Within our 2.9 miles there are 89 road miles; 54 dead ends; 20 road bridges, five underpasses, two outdoor, below grade train lines and several narrow streets. Illegal drop-offs and dumping continue to be a persistent issue in the district, but enforcement tends to land on the property that's already been victimized by the drop off. DSNY refuses to restore MLP. They ask councilmembers to fund cleaning. CD14 has five overlapping councilmembers. There is no way to ensure MLP is provided equitably in the district using this misguided approach. DSNY suggested that we get more MLP now but it seems that they are counting any 311 response as the provision of MLP. This is a baseline service that should be in the baseline budget.

We are extremely grateful for BK14's responsiveness to the needs of our community in general and their interagency work pertinent to storm clean up, homeless encampment conditions, and derelict vehicles that are persistent issues in several locations in the district.

However, policy from above seems poorly coordinated and out of touch with the needs of the very people DSNY is supposed to serve. Vendor enforcement has failed, and this failure has emboldened street vendors such that they are now storing equipment on the sidewalks. The few instances of enforcement in the district resulted in the vendors returning within a day or so. The newly passed charter revision that will provide even more capacity for DSNY will go to waste or worse if inter and intra agency coordination does not improve.

CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DEP	1 / 1	Evaluate a public location or property for green infrastructure, e.g. rain gardens, stormwater greenstreets, green playgrounds

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DEP	1 / 1	Clean catch basins
DSNY	1 / 5	Other cleaning requests
DSNY	2 / 5	Increase enforcement of street vending
DSNY	3 / 5	Provide or expand NYC organics collection program
DSNY	4 / 5	Targeted enforcement
DSNY	5 / 5	Commercial containers

HOUSING, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND LAND USE

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

Other - Write In (Required)

The city has proposed sweeping changes in zoning to achieve more supply in the housing market to increase affordability. This is a scary proposition given that the unique character of several CD14 neighborhoods are threatened by this proposal and the evidence that supply-side trickle-down economics has not empirically proven to meet affordability needs. From 2010-20 CD14 added 2600 units of housing yet the changes in affordability are mixed and generally not impressive. Additionally, the housing stock that does exist has one of the highest rates of serious housing code violations in the city.

Housing code enforcement and building code enforcement are equally important in the district. Only 20% of renter occupied homes are adequately maintained by landlords. CB14 ranks 12th (up from 18th) of 59 community districts in the number of reported serious housing code violations. Housing code violations are correlated with health issues and is a problem underscored by the fact that the district is also one of the most severely rent burdened and overcrowded. Building new affordable housing with no substantial support to ensure that current inventory is maintained is folly. The ratio of newly built affordable housing to market rate housing has decreased. Landlords are able to secure DOB permits to upgrade and upsell units in buildings where outstanding HPD violations exist. Why? Given the fact that over 48% of the area of the district is comprised of 1-2 family homes, combined with the fact that we rank 15th in the city in terms of population density, the renters of multi-family dwellings are highly concentrated. Their dwellings should be safe, healthy and maintained.

Homeownership is up to 26%. The median income of homeowners in CD14 is \$119,880. The median income of renters is \$59,680. In CD 14, the median price of a single-family home rose from \$965K in 2010 to \$1,392,500 in 2023. Prospect Park South, Ditmas Park, Midwood Park-Fiske Terrace, Albermarle-Kenmore Terraces, are all historically landmarked neighborhoods. They comprise 6% of lots in the district, ranking CD14 18th in the City for lots regulated by the Landmarks Preservation Commission. Because the COY HO passed, one councilmember worked with LPC to fastrack two other neighborhoods for landmarking. There was a special permit district in the southern end of the district, which permitted an increase the floor area ratio of single family homes. COY has made this designation obsolete and there will be no further opportunities for local input as expansions will be as of right. Communities should not have to forfeit local input in order to add much needed affordable housing stock.

Community District Needs Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

Needs for Land Use

Proposals should take local community input into account into the formation of land use planning, rather than dropping down fully realized, highly complex documents on volunteer boards and giving them about 40 days to respond. The recent proposals called City of Yes (COY) for Carbon Neutrality, for Economic Opportunity and for Housing Opportunity were complex zoning text amendments. Each had over a dozen proposals within proposals. DCP still has not been able to clearly articulate how the subproposals would interact with one another let alone what the Venn diagram of all three COY proposals looks like. They refused to provide district level environmental impact statements and rushed the myriad details of the proposals through a community board

process inadequately equipped to fully explore local implications. DCP placed zero value on local lived experience, local insight and unique and historic community character. CB14 has been granted a FCNY Planning Fellow who will endeavor to map it out.

Community Board 14 residents live in a mix of housing. From 2010 to 2020 over 2600 units of housing were added to the CD14 stock. However, housing costs have increased and the share of affordable housing does not match the need. For instance, only 6% of units are affordable at 30% AMI, but 25% of residents are at or below that income level. CD14 ranks 7th in the city in the severe overcrowding rate. In addition, the district is disproportionately rent burdened, with 50% of low-income renter households severely burdened, meaning that rent is at least 50% of household income.

CB14 ranks high and number of serious housing code violations in increasing alarmingly. There are 800 housing code violations per 1000 units of housing in the district. Approximately 250 of them are serious housing code violations. Some buildings have 100s of violations. At least one building in the district has had three fires that resulted in the displacement of tenants. Clean, safe and well maintained housing accounts for 80-90% of community health outcomes. Building new affordable housing is folly if there are no effective efforts to preserve the current stock of affordable units.

Needs for Housing

The District ranks 7th in the rate of severe overcrowding in renter households. The rate of severely rent overburdened households is 29% For households in poverty it is 44%! These are households spending 50% or more of their income on gross rent. This is harrowing given that being rent burdened and overcrowded contributes to homelessness. Addressing violations, and providing preventative support services, as well as adding affordable housing to the housing inventory must occur simultaneously and urgently. While numbers of housing units have increased, the ratio of affordable housing has decreased. There was a broadly expressed concern that the City of Yes for Housing does not demand any deep affordability and that most of the promise of increasing any affordability rests on market forces.

Needs for Economic Development

There are several commercial strips in the district serving the needs of residents and attracting commerce from other parts of the city as well as tourism. Many small independent stores line Church Avenue, Cortelyou Road, Avenues J and M and Coney Island Avenue, Flatbush Avenue and Newkirk Plaza. There are two Business Improvement Districts covering three corridors: Flatbush Nostrand Junction, Flatbush and Church Avenue - and three merchant associations in our community. We face notable challenges in maximizing commercial activity throughout the District. Triangle Junction shopping mall still has Target as its anchor store. The City continues to refuse to assign Newkirk Plaza to DOT or an appropriate agency to allow enforcement, services, and programming for economic development. The Kings Theatre, a 3300 seat live performance venue, which was a \$90 million economic development investment now must manage with the placement of a 200 bed homeless shelter practically on its loading dock. The theater was to provide a vital link in Brooklyn's cultural corridor and offer spillover opportunities for surrounding merchants. They must be well supported to spur economic activity.

HOUSING, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND LAND USE

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
HPD	1 / 2	More affordable housing for low and extremely low income households
HPD	2 / 2	Low income, supportive and senior housing

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DOB	1 / 2	Address illegal conversions and uses of buildings
DOB	2 / 2	Assign additional building inspectors (including expanding training programs)
HPD	1 / 2	Provide more housing for extremely low and low income households
HPD	2 / 2	Provide, expand, or enhance programs for housing inspections to correct code violations
SBS	1 / 1	Provide commercial lease support for business owners

TRANSPORTATION AND MOBILITY

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Transportation and Mobility

Other - Write In (Required)

Year after year the Department of Transportation has the greatest number of outstanding service delivery requests in CD14. This is due to the sheer number of requests combined with the length of time it takes DOT to address service delivery items. For years we have advocated for Newkirk Plaza's adoption into the DOT pedestrian plaza program. It took nearly 10 years for DOT to agree. In 204 DOT said that it was imminent. We have been waiting yet another year for an agreement with MTA to be finalized.

It can also take years for DOT to address baseline service requests such as speed reducers, signs, traffic lights, streetlights, etc. We have 12 years of record of requests to slow traffic on Argyle off of Avenue H. It is increasingly difficult to get DOT to repair street infrastructure. As of last year DOT indicated that they won't even consider a trench repair unless it is part of a total road reconstruction. DOT denies responsibility for assets they used to maintain such as dead-end infrastructure. There are 54 dead ends in CD 14, most abut railway or subway tracks and need to be walled off in some way for safety. If DOT is not responsible for maintenance, then who?

As DOT's portfolio grows to include Open Streets, Citibike expansion, electric vehicle charging stations, reserved car share parking, residential streets delivery windows and Amazon sidewalk lockers, while expanding express bus lanes and the bike lane network, it is unclear how competing uses are prioritized. While the relationship with transportation advocates seems robust, DOT has been woeful in gathering community input from outside of those groups. They presented that they had done outreach in Midwood, but had not ventured south of Avenue J. DOT gathers input on their portals but must balance that self-select input with community outreach.

Freight mobility continues to be a problem which is exacerbated by the onslaught of 53' trucks on our streets. The Caton Avenue truck route is used as a through-route although it is designated as a local route on the DOT truck route map. It is nearly always congested and the Citibike stations require riders to step into the truck route, even on Parade Ground side of the street, where the station could have been on the extra wide sidewalk. Church Avenue, which is technically the through route, according to the DOT truck route map, is congested and includes an express bus lane for several streets. The Beverly Road bridge was partially repaired to allow parking and local truck traffic, but there is no timeframe for remaining repairs. The Parkside bridge is prioritized for capital repair, yet we have no timeframe for this work either and the Newkirk Avenue bridge cannot be added to a component contract because Newkirk Plaza has not been assigned to the purview of a city agency. DOT initiates proposals for bike paths, pedestrian islands, and pedestrian plazas. While gathering local input is time-consuming and often messy, the end result is inevitably better when there is stakeholder buy in. DOT's agreement to move a Citibike station after just a few months in evidence that valuing local input in the first place would have been more efficient. It is important for local voices to be heard at the inception of a plan, not after DOT has completed proposals without local insight.

Community District Needs Related to Transportation and Mobility

Needs for Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure

New York City must take responsibility for Newkirk Plaza - America's first-ever outdoor shopping plaza. The clearest solution is for the Plaza to become a formal participant in the DOT's Pedestrian Plaza Program. It took years to get DOT to agree to accept the plaza into its program and now it's taken over a year for DOT and MTA to begin implementation. Meanwhile, Newkirk Plaza has several

chronic issues unresolved, including a serious rodent infestation, sanitation maintenance concerns, disrepair of the brick plaza surface, and growing street homelessness challenges. Because DOT and MTA cannot move the plan forward, several other resources must be tapped. The New York City Police Department, the Department of Sanitation, the Department of Buildings, and the Department of Health and Mental Hygiene, have all been called upon to deal with myriad issues on the Plaza. Many community stakeholders, including business owners, civic and community-based organizations, and local government entities, continue to struggle to meet these challenges with little support and no permanent resolution in sight. In the recent past, DOT provided FDC with minimal, finite funding to support limited sanitation services, painted the corrugated wall (which is DOT's responsibility) and offered but did not follow through on adding the Plaza to the SAPO system. None of these steps resolved the longstanding concerns. Once added to the DOT plaza program, it would be transformed into a vibrant, social public space, as per DOT's Plaza Program stated mission. Businesses and community groups will provide additional programming for the community that will also serve as an economic development catalyst. It's well past due.

All types of transportation are important in District 14. Within the 2.9 miles that comprise the District, there are 89.2 road miles, 54 dead end streets, two through truck routes, several road bridges over the Brighton Line and Atlantic RR tracks and approximately 1200 street segments. Given its Central Brooklyn location and number of thoroughfares in the District including Flatbush Avenue, Coney Island Avenue, Ocean Parkway, Nostrand Avenue running north/south; and Church Avenue, Cortelyou Road, Foster Avenue and Avenues J and M going east/west, traffic and road conditions are constant concerns. Car free commuting has leveled back up toward 2010's 74% to 73% in 2023 after falling to 62% in 2021.

Community Board 14 service delivery data show that DOT requests outnumber those of any other agency with which the Community Board interacts. Part of the reason for this accumulation is the time-lag for many DOT issue responses. Responsiveness and community input are important. Of great concern is that there is no way to ascertain an overview of DOT traffic calming measures. CB14 processes hundreds of DOT service delivery requests, but there is no way to understand how implementation of all or any combination of these requests would impact traffic flow in the district. DOT acknowledges that studies are infrequent and that cost-benefit analyses are not standard.

There are nine subway stations, seven of which are Brighton Line outdoor tracks, therefore track work affects road traffic. There are also 15 bus lines that operate in the district including express buses and select bus service routes. CB14 has advocated for the return of the B23 but now the bus redesign anticipates removing all buses from commercial Cortelyou Road and using residential Beverley Road.

Needs for Transit Services

There are nine subway stations in the District: one Culver Line IND stop; one IRT terminal stop and the remainder Brighton Line BMT stops. Most of the Brighton Line stations have been updated - some in full, others partial renovations. However the Church Avenue station is in serious need of rehabilitation. A public private partnership to install an elevator and make this heavily utilized station ADA compliant is very welcome. Additional improvements should be included to limit ridership inconvenient during upgrade work. We look forward to accessibility improvements and hope they will expand to the Culver line. We have asked MTA NYCT to provide us with station capacity data to take into consideration when new developments are proposed so that we can better predict the impact on local transit. This is especially urgent at the Cortelyou Road station.

CB 14 will work to maximize community input on MTA's Fast Forward Brooklyn Bus Network Redesign. This community has long advocated for the restoration of the B23 on Cortelyou Road but instead the plan currently considers removing all buses (which now only include express lines) from commercial Cortelyou Road and redirecting them to residential Beverley Road. One of the stated reasons is that the right turn from westbound Cortelyou to northbound Coney Island Avenue has been made more difficult to navigate due to DOT installations. There needs to be forward

thinking coordination so that plans do not chase after unintended consequences. The community garden on the exterior side of the Church Avenue Brighton Line station house continues to be a positive addition to the community and should serve as a model for use of the commons. It is unfortunate that Transit will not take the same creative initiative with Newkirk Plaza. The East 15th Street MTA house once issued an RFP for development but is now once again back in the hands of MTA and is once again a fallow lot and an eyesore. This property should be RFPed again, or offered an MOU for a garden or operationalized and maintained.



BROOKLYN COMMUNITY BOARD 14
FLATBUSH-MIDWOOD COMMUNITY DISTRICT
810 East 16th Street
Brooklyn, New York 11230

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Member-at-Large

ALVIN M. BERK
Chairman Emeritus

June 30, 2023

Ydanis Rodriguez
Commissioner
Department of Transportation
55 Water Street, 9th Floor
New York, NY 10041

Dear Commissioner Rodriguez,

I am writing to express concerns with the process by which DOT has expanded the Lyft Citi Bike stations in our community and to submit follow-up questions pertaining to the stations based on additional feedback from community members.

On March 8, 2023, CB14's Transportation Committee hosted a preliminary presentation by DOT regarding proposed Citi Bike stations in CD14. The proposed locations were reported to have been based on several virtual stakeholder meetings and over 600 comments. Please provide the dates of those virtual meetings. We were also informed at the time that DOT would follow up with site-specific outreach and notification to all adjacent property owners.

However, when this plan, with some adjustments, was presented again to the CB14 Transportation Committee on June 8, 2023, residents in proximity to the stations were taken by surprise and raised various objections. Please clarify and substantiate how and when notifications were provided to adjacent property owners.

It is also our understanding that DOT didn't coordinate with the MTA. Please review the proposed station on Caton Avenue in front of the Church Avenue Brighton Line station, to which MTA objects. Please provide assurance that DOT will relocate the bike station, which would otherwise interfere with riders' transfer to and from the bus stop and station house, as per MTA's analysis.

Please also reconsider the proposed station's position on East 18th Street and Church Avenue, which blocks pedestrian access to the community garden. This is at the request of volunteer community gardeners who have worked very hard to beautify and program a previously forlorn block.

Some residents object to the proposed station on Westminster Road, off Beverley Road. Their concerns are myriad and have been shared directly with DOT with alternative suggestions. Concerns about the interplay of stations on Beverley Road with shared bike lanes, vehicular volume, and the potential change in express bus routes have not been satisfactorily addressed by DOT.

There are also concerns with the proposed station on Rugby Road, off Church Avenue. The residents on Rugby Road already feel abandoned by city agencies that have not been able to ameliorate flooding on the block and now believe that the proposed bike stations will exacerbate those conditions. Is DOT able to demonstrate that these concerns are unfounded? Could you assist with flooding concerns while you're at it?

At the June 8th presentation, DOT reported that locations in the Parade Ground were still being discussed with the Department of Parks and Recreation. Please advise as to where the stations in the Parade Ground will be located. DOT has promised on several locations that the other stations on Caton Avenue that back into the truck route were to be more safely situated, but that has not come to fruition. Please address this urgent safety matter.

It is regrettable that DOT was not able to propose more requested stations along Cortelyou Road or further to the south near Newkirk Plaza. I trust that when this is considered, we can work together to ensure robust community outreach.

In the meantime, please provide the contract between DOT and Lyft. When the public right of way is transferred to a for-profit entity regardless of the taxpayer's opinions and the opportunity costs of all other public uses, we believe there should be maximum transparency in that arrangement.

I look forward to your response on these particulars and a general improvement in transparency and process.

Sincerely,



Shawn Campbell
District Manager

cc: Hon. Rita Joseph, Councilmember, 40th CD
Keith Bray, Brooklyn Borough Commissioner, DOT



BROOKLYN COMMUNITY BOARD 14
FLATBUSH–MIDWOOD COMMUNITY DISTRICT
810 East 16th Street
Brooklyn, New York 11230

ERIC L. ADAMS
Mayor

ANTONIO REYNOSO
Borough President

KARL-HENRY CESAR
Chair

SHAWN CAMPBELL
District Manager

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

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DEBORAH VALENTIN
Member-at-Large

ALVIN M. BERK
Chairman Emeritus

March 25, 2024

Paige Graves
General Counsel,
New York City Transit Authority
2 Broadway
New York, NY 10004

Dear Ms. Graves,

Since 2012, Community Board 14 members and the community at large have advocated for a settlement of the jurisdictional issues related to Newkirk Plaza (the “Plaza”) by urging its admission into the Department of Transportation’s (DOT’s) Pedestrian Plaza program. It is our current understanding that DOT has approached MTA/New York City Transit Authority (“MTA/NYCTA”) about this issue, but the matter has stalled in MTA’s real estate unit. If MTA/NYCTA cannot or will not settle on an agreement with DOT, NYCTA must nonetheless accept its responsibility to participate in the maintenance and security for the Plaza, whose open-air publicly accessible walkways provide, among other things, the only access to the Plaza subway station serving the B & Q trains.

As set forth herein, after exhaustive review of the underlying documentation, there is clear and convincing proof that NYCTA, as the long-term leaseholder of the portions of the Plaza nearest the center cut-out created for the subway station – and easement holder over additional property within the Plaza – bears responsibility, at a minimum, to participate in the preservation and security of the Plaza which our residents and your commuters utilize daily. In short, as a way to resolve the prolonged stalemate on this matter, we ask for NYCTA, as a shared party to the Plaza, to join with DOT and/or the Flatbush Development Corporation (“FDC”) and neighboring property owners to enter a joint maintenance and security agreement allowing for all affected parties to participate in a solution for the Plaza’s future.

By way of background, CB14 has strived for decades to resolve the issues plaguing the Plaza. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit A** is representative prior correspondence, including a 1992 letter from NYCTA to then-Congressman Schumer advising that a title search was to be completed to resolve the issue – this apparently was never done.) As a summary of CB14’s work, we set forth the following:

- In 1986, a coalition was formed to identify a mix of public and private funding for sanitation, maintenance, and lighting at the Plaza.
- In 1992, then-Borough President Howard Golden allocated \$500,000 to fix the sidewalks.
- In 1994, NYCTA repaired the surface of the Plaza in order to protect their station beneath.
- In 2011 and 2018, DOT agreed to paint the corrugated metal walls along Newkirk and Foster Avenues.
- In 2018, NYCTA agreed to repair the iron fencing inside the Plaza to protect their assets below.

Of note, none of these projects were improvements – they were necessary repairs.

Most recently, during the de Blasio administration, then-Borough President Eric Adams was a signatory to efforts to reach a resolution to these problems. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit B** is the letter to the de Blasio administration, dated January 29, 2020, which did not receive a further response.) Now that Eric Adams is Mayor, the timing seems propitious for reaching an acceptable solution to this decades-long wait.

With the aid of Lucy Phillips, CB14's 2022 Planning Fellow from the Fund for the City of New York, as well as years of work by a local researcher, Dr. Joseph Enright, CB14 has compiled the following evidence explaining why NYCTA is responsible for part of the maintenance of the Plaza. As set forth below, due to the apparent bifurcated control of the Plaza, and the prior and continued commitment from the FDC, it is clear that the most appropriate solution to ensure the future protection and vibrancy of the Plaza is to have NYCTA enter and fund a joint maintenance and security agreement for the Plaza.¹

History of the Plaza

The origin of the Plaza dates back to the creation of the two track Brooklyn, Flatbush and Coney Island Railroad in 1878, a surface line which transported primarily recreation-seeking passengers to a new Brighton Beach resort at the southern edge of Kings County.² Today's Newkirk Plaza stop was originally known as the "Parkville" station, which was situated on the north side of Newkirk Avenue, on the eastern side of the tracks.³ The original right-of-way was 50 feet wide. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit E** are the original granting documents from around 1878 which we obtained from the MTA. See, for instance, the middle of page 2 of same for a reference to the 50 ft. width – many contemporaneous publications reference the same dimension.) As development came to the area along this Brighton line, it became necessary to either elevate or depress the tracks below ground to avoid accidents and allow for a freer flow of traffic at roadway crossings. Thus, in 1903 New York State formed the Brooklyn Grade Crossing Commission (the

¹ It should be noted that most recently, in 2022 the FDC filed an application with the DOT for the Plaza to enter its Pedestrian Plaza Program. As with the other similar efforts since 2012, the DOT has not yet responded to this filing. Notwithstanding that it does not appear the DOT owns or controls any portion of the Plaza, it still appears that the best result would be, with the cooperation of NYCTA, that the Plaza be designated as a Pedestrian Plaza under this Program.

² "History of the Work of Eliminated Grade Crossings by the Brooklyn Grade Crossing Commission," Brooklyn Grade Crossing Commission, April 30, 1918, at 9. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit C**.) A video based largely on contemporaneous photos and documents has been created by CB14 to illustrate the unique history discussed herein and can be accessed at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8LT_tLQP73s.

³ Sanborn Map from 1890, Map 499. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit D**.)

“Commission”), which inter alia mediated issues involving the newly re-named South Midwood station.⁴ By this point, the rail line had been acquired by a subsidiary of Brooklyn Rapid Transit (“BRT”), who now operated it as a busy electrified daily commuter line for the increasingly developed areas of southern Brooklyn.⁵

The Commission approved a plan to depress a four-track railroad 15 feet below grade and create an express station at South Midwood, between Newkirk and Foster Avenues. This meant that the existing 50 ft. right-of-way would need to be expanded to allow for two island platforms accommodating local and express trains, and thick retaining walls to ensure structural stability for the station.⁶ (Attached hereto as **Exhibit F** is the current tax map showing the dimensions of Newkirk Plaza as an unmapped lot, which is greater than 50 ft. in width.) To accomplish this, the BRT negotiated easements with property owners: a 2-foot easement for each retaining wall and, in exchange for an additional 12.5-foot easement on each side of the right-of-way, it would deck over the entire length and width of the extra easement. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit G** is the original easement-granting documentation we obtained from the MTA.) These original granting documents provided to the neighboring property owners, among other things, “. . . the right to use as a yard, all that part of the roof over the station platform to be erected by [the BRT] . . .”⁷ Most telling is the grant by Henry F. Newbury and his wife Anna E. Newbury (*see* Exhibit G at page 13), which provides in relevant part that the easement shall be:

“. . . conditioned upon the faithful performance by [the BRT] of the following covenants, I. That [the BRT] shall and will establish and forever maintain . . . a suitable platform or walk not less than ten (10) feet in width at all points of the length, except at its end portions adjacent to Foster and Newkirk Avenues, where such walk or platform shall be widened to a line parallel to and distant not less than twenty-two (22) feet, nine (9) inches westerly from the easterly line of the end portions of the strip of land herein described, for the use of passengers and others in entering and leaving said building, and such platform or walk shall be located and forever maintained at for about the level of the surface of the strip of land described herein . . . and such platform or walk shall at its most westerly portion be provided with a guard railing or fence, not less than four (4) feet, six (6) inches in height, which shall be forever maintained . . .”.

(Emphasis added.)

These same easement rights carried through subsequent deeds for the neighboring properties. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit H** is a compendium of deeds compiled by Dr. Enright which reference the easement grants, and in particular the Newbury easement.)⁸

⁴ See note 2, at 5. See also, “Improvement of the Brighton Beach Line of the Brooklyn Heights Railroad Company,” *Electric Railway Review*, December 1906, at 968. The station’s name would be changed again in 1907 to Newkirk Avenue, and to Newkirk Plaza in 2011.

⁵ See note 2.

⁶ “Improvement of the Brighton Beach Line of the Brooklyn Heights Railroad Company,” note 4, at 969.

⁷ See Exhibit G at the top of page 3 and the middle of page 8. See also, “Improvement of the Brighton Beach Line of the Brooklyn Heights Railroad Company,” note 4, at 969.

⁸ Accompanying documentation is available upon request.

Ownership of the Plaza

These easement agreements outline the understood operation and ownership of the Plaza. Specifically, the portion of the Plaza deck closest to the center cut-out, and within the original 50 ft. right-of-way, appears to be controlled by Transit (as successor to the BRT), and the balance of the Plaza, while part of the easement grant to the BRT, was controlled by the adjacent property owners.⁹ In addition, within the easement documents, the adjacent property owners were granted “a right of way over so much of the land belonging to the [BRT], . . . as lies west of a line drawn parallel to and distance six feet westerly from the easterly boundary line of the land . . . for the benefit only of the owners of the premises herein described, their employees, tenants or persons doing business with them, or either of them”.¹⁰

It should be noted that for the westerly side of the Plaza, a large multi-state realty corporation, Wood, Harmon & Company, operating as Greater New York Development Company, had purchased a large section of the vacant land adjoining that right-of-way and conveyed a portion thereof to the railroad in March, 1906, in exchange for easements, the nature of which could not be located other than by citations in subsequent deeds to “Liber 50, Page 316, dated 3/9/1906.” [Note: Contemporaneous litigation revealed Wood, Harmon – and the east side property owners as well – were all eager recipients of thousands of pounds of dirt excavated from the Cut in order to bring their vacant land up to the grade level of the new decks.] The only other property on the west side was a long-standing hotel abutting the railroad’s right-of-way at the northwest end, at the corner of Marlborough Road and Newkirk Avenue. A reference in litigation related to construction of the retaining walls indicates the railroad via the Commission obtained control of at least part of the property by condemnation, also in March 1906.¹¹ The lack of an easement with the recalcitrant hotel owner explains why the deck on the west side ends at precisely where that hotel sat.

Simply put, the BRT and the adjacent parcel owners appear to have created a mutual access agreement across each other’s portions of the Plaza. Further, the Newbury grant outlines how the BRT, and now NYCTA, bear the responsibility for maintenance of the Plaza.

In 1915, the aforementioned Henry Fitch Newbury tested this designation of respective control by building a “spite” fence around his portion of the Plaza, leaving the remaining eight feet nearest the portion of the Station open to the sky as an accessway to the subway station.¹² The magistrate court’s dismissal of the charge against Newbury, prompted by disgruntled community members, demonstrates the original parties’ understanding of the easement agreements. In short, aside from maintenance of the retaining wall below the Plaza, the portion of the Plaza on the adjacent property owners’ side would be controlled by the respective owners, while the portion within the original 50 ft. right-of-way would remain under the control and operation of the BRT and its successors.

⁹ See generally Exhibits G and H.

¹⁰ See *id.*

¹¹ See *id.* The lack of development on the five lots south of the corner hotel that comprise the west side of the Plaza until 1916 to 1921 might have been attributable to the absence of a Newbury-like easement with Wood, Harmon. It also might explain why it was agreeable to the demands of Newbury et alia – who developed the east side in 1910 – that no entrance to the Station be built on the east side so as to grant them a “retail monopoly,” and why that west entrance was not built until November 1915.

¹² “Talk of Spite Fence Arouses Flatbush,” Brooklyn Eagle, August 24, 1915. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit I.**)

Moreover, the development of the Plaza supports the view that the BRT and its successors have never relinquished control over the portion of the Plaza within the original 50 ft. right-of-way. In 1953, the City and NYCTA entered a long-term lease to set forth the control that NYCTA has held ever since. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit J** is a copy of the lease.) Therein, the “Leased Property” is defined as, in relevant part, “. . . the transit facilities and any other materials, supplies and **property incidental to or necessary for the operation of such transit facilities . . .**” (Emphasis added.) As the walkway leading to the Newkirk Plaza subway station is indeed necessary for the operation of the transit stop, it is part of the property still under control of NYCTA. This conclusion is supported by the subsequent behavior by NYCTA. In 1977, NYCTA entered an agreement with FDC and the Newkirk Plaza Merchants Association to repave the entire Plaza. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit K** is the Agreement.) While the Merchants Association was designated as having sole responsibility over repairs to the pavers, NYCTA still “. . . **agrees that it shall continue to be responsible for those portions of Newkirk Plaza which are in any way subject to its jurisdiction.**” (Emphasis added.) This would include that portion of the Plaza within the original 50 ft. right-of-way. The issue of maintenance of the sidewalk outside of the Newkirk Plaza station came up again in 1991, as evidenced by a *Daily News* article. It does not appear a solution was reached until 1994 (discussed above), as NYCTA advised at the time that they were going to “review” the deeds. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit L** is a portion of this article.)

The same continued responsibility appears to be applicable to the western side of the Plaza – from the very beginning. In February 1916, Henry Fitch Newbury sued the BRT, requesting a temporary injunction to prohibit it from using the entrance on the western side of the station which had opened in November 1915. Newbury lost this case, presumably (there is no published opinion – Newbury died 18 months after his filing) because the court determined that the BRT retained control over the portion of the Plaza still within the 50 ft. right-of-way.¹³

Through the ensuing decades of the original easement grants, the BRT passed control of what became known as the Brighton Line to various subsidiaries, until, in 1940, the City of New York took control of the BRT’s successor, the BMT. (Attached hereto is **Exhibit M** which is the grant of same.) In 1953, NYCTA was created to manage the overall subway system and became a subsidiary of the MTA when that agency was created in 1968. This has been the ownership structure ever since. **Exhibit N** provides a timeline outlining the various owners, 1878-Present.

As such, the portion of the Plaza within the original 50 ft. right-of-way (approximately six to ten feet on either side) appears to be currently controlled by, and quite clearly the responsibility of NYCTA, as owner of the long-term leasehold over same. As NYCTA appears to control, and the city owns, at least a portion of the Plaza (something which would need to be surveyed to confirm the exact location of same), the duty falls partially on them to maintain and allow for proper policing of same. Arguably, maintenance responsibility for at least 10' of the Plaza (and wider at the northerly and southerly ends) would fall under NYCTA, based on the original Newbury grant. In general, liability for sidewalks within the City falls on abutting property owners.¹⁴ Here, however, the sidewalk is partially located upon the property controlled by NYCTA. As such, general premises liability rules would apply. This fact alone should motivate NYCTA to arrive at a suitable solution.

¹³ “Would Close Entrance at Newkirk Station,” *Brooklyn Standard Union*, February 14, 1916. (Attached hereto as **Exhibit N**.)

¹⁴ See New York City Administrative Code § 7-210 and § 19-152

Conclusion

Taken together, the above information and analysis points to no other conclusion but that NYCTA retains certain responsibilities over the maintenance and security of at least a portion of the Plaza. Notwithstanding the method, with NYCTA, FDC and the neighboring property owners' cooperation, it would appear that the clear solution is to have participation by all representative parties in achieving a future maintenance and security plan for the Plaza. If MTA/NYCTA has not found a way to accept DOT's stewardship via the Pedestrian Plaza program, clearly the second-best path forward is to negotiate and fund a joint maintenance and security agreement to ensure the future vitality of the Plaza and the surrounding community.

Just last month, CB14 rejected an OCM application for a new cannabis dispensary in the Plaza due to the uncertainties involved in the continued policing and maintenance of this important public space within our District. As the urgency in solving this issue remains strong, given the ongoing and constantly emerging issues at the Plaza, we respectfully request your response without delay to schedule a meeting to discuss further.

Thank you for your consideration of the foregoing, and we look forward to your response.

Best regards,



Karl-Henry Cesar
Chair
Brooklyn Community Board 14



Shawn Campbell
District Manager
Brooklyn Community Board 14

cc: Janno Lieber, President and CEO, MTA
Richard Davey, President, NYCT
Ydonis Rodriguez, Commissioner, DOT
Hon. Kevin Parker, NYS Senate, 21st District
Hon. Rodneyse Bichotte Hermelyn, NYS Assembly, 42nd District
Hon. Farah Louis, NYC Council, 45th CD
Robin Redmond, Executive Director, FDC
Gregory Alvarez, Co-Chair, CB14 Housing and Land Use Committee



BROOKLYN COMMUNITY BOARD 14
FLATBUSH-MIDWOOD COMMUNITY DISTRICT
810 East 16th Street
Brooklyn, New York 11230

March 28, 2024

Keith Bray
Brooklyn Borough Commissioner
Department of Transportation
16 Court Street, 1620
Brooklyn, NY 11241

Dear Commissioner Bray,

I am writing to invite you back to the drawing board to resolve the public safety issues on Lawrence Avenue. This continues to be a public safety concern.

We have been actively seeking a remedy for traffic and safety concerns on Lawrence Avenue and the surrounding blocks since 2016 when CB14 first asked for a traffic study in the vicinity of the 70th Precinct house. The issues that existed then, exist now but to a greater extreme. There is an increase in personnel at the precinct, programs at Adapt Community Network (fka United Cerebral Palsy) are robust and reliant on Department of Education busing organized by the Office for Pupil Transportation. There are two new schools in the area and another that has been approved at 50 Lawrence Avenue. In addition, there are at least five new residential developments in the area. I have always been concerned; now I am alarmed.

DOT must act.

In May of 2016 we requested a traffic study. (Attachment A). In June of 2017, DOT agreed to study the area. (Attachment B). In December of 2017, based on that study DOT offered to create a right turn bay on Foster at Ocean Parkway, which was implemented. DOT offered a left turn ban from Ocean Parkway onto Foster, but this was considered ill-advised by the precinct and ultimately not implemented.

There have been several other requests for consideration that DOT has rejected outright or never conclusively responded to, including:

- A turning bay from Seton onto Foster was put on the back burner but DOT installed a traffic signal following the pedestrian fatality of a child crossing Foster by Seton in 2019. That signal is not timed to allow more than one bus to turn which creates gridlock at Parkville, Lawrence, and Webster, during school drop offs and dismissals and beyond. A request to review the signal timing has been submitted: # DOT-642365-P5P4.
- Create a loading bay at 175 Lawrence Avenue. A curb cut/loading bay would allow buses to pull in closer to the building, allowing through traffic to pass.
- Make Seton one way in opposite directions from Lawrence Avenue so that vehicles would be able to turn right or left, better distributing traffic between Foster and 18th Avenue.

- Reverse the one-way direction of Parkville and/or Webster. These suggestions were made secondary to returning the one-way direction of Lawrence Avenue, which was originally an eastbound street.

Reversing the direction of Lawrence Avenue eastbound would return it to its original layout and rationalize the grid. All stakeholders would benefit with one glaring exception, which is Adapt Community Network. Adapt has asserted for years the need to maintain the westbound pattern so that the doors of buses align with the doors of their program site, which is important for their clients who use wheelchairs. We have been and continue to be sympathetic to this convenience but are not convinced that it is a necessity. First, they have programs on both sides of the street. Second, Adapt has a pedestrian bridge over Lawrence so they could coordinate pick up on either side of the street. Third, it is hard to imagine that every program in New York City serving people in wheelchairs has a site with doors to the right of buses. What do other program facilities do?

In December of 2021, a variance application for a school at 50 Lawrence came before CB14 and a traffic study was offered but does not seem to have ever come to fruition. Therefore, we have no additional data to draw upon to predict whether this school will be the breaking point.

The changing conditions noted above necessitate an updated study and it is imperative the DOT come back to the community with solutions. We are happy to coordinate a site visit to renew DOT's understanding and update the relevant DOT representatives on new, exacerbated conditions. We'd also be glad to facilitate a stakeholder meeting in conjunction or separate from or even in lieu of a site visit. Please indicate your preference.

In the meantime, anything you can do to expedite the review of the signal timing on Seton would be appreciated. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,



Shawn Alyse Campbell
District Manager

cc: Commissioner Ydanis Rodriguez, Department of Transportation
Hon. Simcha Felder, NYS Senate, 22nd SD
Hon. Simcha Eichenstein, NYS Assembly, 48th AD
Hon. Rita Joseph, NYC Council, 40th CD
Hon. Kalman Yeger, NYC Council, 44th CD
Deputy Inspector Gregory Mackie, Commanding Officer, 70th Police Precinct

TRANSPORTATION AND MOBILITY

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DOT	1 / 3	Rehabilitate bridges
DOT	2 / 3	Roadway maintenance (resurfacing, trench restoration, etc.)
DOT	3 / 3	Other transportation infrastructure requests
NYCTA	1 / 2	Repair or upgrade subway stations or other transit infrastructure
NYCTA	2 / 2	Improve accessibility of transit infrastructure, by providing elevators, escalators, etc.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DOT	1 / 2	Other expense budget request for DOT
DOT	2 / 2	Address traffic congestion
NYCTA	1 / 2	Address overcrowded buses
NYCTA	2 / 2	Newkirk Plaza

PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Brooklyn Community Board 14

Most Important Issue Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

Other - Write In (Required)

New York is a city of neighborhoods. The Community Board is instrumental in ensuring that cultural and park programming; community facilities; forestry services; library facilities and services; public space maintenance; park safety; quality library programming, are accessible to the public and maintained by the appropriate agencies. Community service delivery requests for sanitation, abandoned vehicles, fallen tree branches, requests for public health, safety and voting information and so many other requests have increased or changed in nature. Citywide policies, zoning changes, and new rules might have different impacts in different districts. The many needs we have identified in previous years that remain unfunded only served to underscore inequities in our district. A healthy, vibrant, and economically sound community depends on getting service, support and input to/from the local community level. That is our role; that is where Community Boards are expert.

The number of service delivery requests have increased, the number of proposals to consider have increased, the number of meetings and events continue to increase, training requirements and new mandates have increased, however, community board funding has not. Community Boards are one of the few city agencies that have not significantly expanded budget since 2016 or funded headcount ever. The extent to which the city does not support community boards and their district office staff, is the extent to which they simply don't support local needs and input.

Community Board 14 is 59th out of 59 community districts citywide in terms of the number of residents who live more than a quarter of a mile away from a park. New open space upgraded, and well-maintained existing parks and playgrounds are high priorities. Maintenance and upgrades of all existing parks and playgrounds are a must. Capital funding for parks should be in DPR's budget so that parks can be developed and maintained according to need, not political gifts. This is a matter of equity. Prospect Park's Lakeshore project would be an excellent example of capitalizing a project for one agency that would have positive impacts for several programs across agencies such as DOT, DEP, SBS. Expanded parks access, expanding healthy ecosystems, capturing stormwater for irrigation, mitigating flooding that damages streets, homes and business should represent enough wins to get this project fully funded. Funding for Parks projects that values our community's local importance in a broad historical context should secure ongoing funding for the Flatbush African Burial Ground, which must be developed appropriately and with the descendant community's input at the forefront. Rigorous outreach to maximize inclusion is needed to ensure that stakeholders are identified and expanded and provided every opportunity to be heard. The Shirley Chisholm monument must have an accompanying educational welcome center for do her legacy justice.

As for the daily needs outside of park property, it is clear that the baseline budget for tree pruning and emergency pruning is not yet robust enough to meet the needs of CD14. Just because the tree pruning cycle has improved doesn't mean it is adequate. The number of complaints and the time to resolve are both up in CD14. Parks capacity should be augmented with better coordination and an expansion of the Citizens Tree Pruners program. Parks should be better coordinated with DCP and DOB to ensure developer compliance with tree planting requirements.

Our libraries are needed more than ever. We urge the city to reimagine the design of libraries to increase resiliency and maintain access in response to public health emergencies. The Cortelyou Road Library is a one-story building with a deep set-back. It seems ripe for expansion.

Community District Needs Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

Needs for Parks

See capital expense request 17-20 and expense requests 30-25.

Residents of CD 14 live further away from a park than any other District in the entire City of New York, with over 70% living a quarter mile away or more. The largest park in our district is the Parade Ground at our northern border, which includes 40 acres of athletic fields, and tennis courts available primarily by permit. Areas that offer open access such as the Det. Dillon Stewart playground and the adult fitness area, are heavily utilized. Kolbert Park is in the southern end of the District and the Deputy Inspector Joseph DiGilio Playground is in the west. Umma Park is a small playground over the BMT tracks in the northeastern end of the District, which has antiquated play equipment and no greenery. There are also two tot lots in the District - on Cortelyou Road and on Campus Road. The Campus Road tot lot has never been updated. The Department itself must be adequately resourced to maintain its own inventory, instead of relying on funding provided by elected officials. While Umma Park has finally received funding through Councilmember Rita Joseph's office, it was a long time coming. It's hard to believe that Parks would have delayed so long if the Department held the pocket book.

The identification of additional space for parkland and additional greening of green streets areas is essential in our park-poor community. In 2017 a Planning Fellow provided by the Fund for the City of New York researched and provided recommendations for greening CD14.

Prospect Park's Lakeshore project would enhance park access and programming and will have positive environmental and maintenance impacts, including flood mitigation. The Flatbush African Burial Ground will be constructed as a memorial through the Department of Parks and Recreation. CB14 highly prioritizes funding that is adequate to fully realize a descendent community driven vision of this sacred and historic site. This is a high priority for our community. Newly added this year is CB14's support for an education and welcome center to complement the Shirley Chisholm monument to be installed (after significant delay) at the Parkside entrance to Prospect Park.

Needs for Cultural Services

See capital expense request 17-20 and expense requests 30-25.

The cultural institutions in our community will need focused support. Performing arts venues create social capital and economic spillover effects. Situated at the approximate center of Flatbush Avenue, the Kings Theatre serves as a cultural fulcrum of Brooklyn's Cultural Corridor. It has sponsored and supported myriad community events.

Community based arts organizations tend to be small but are valued in the community. Public funding opportunities, including coordination with libraries, schools, senior centers, shelters, and other local institutions should be more broadly supported.

Needs for Library Services

See capital expense request 17-20 and expense requests 30-25.

District 14's four existing branch libraries are heavily used and highly valued by the community. The Board continues to strongly support essential improvements needed at these locations and advocated for keeping libraries open seven days a week. Our local branch libraries provide programs and services that relate in important ways to our communities such as the Caribbean Literacy and Cultural Center at the Flatbush Branch, and the Cortelyou Road library's teamwork with other community groups. It is important to ensure that libraries are maintained to maximize healthy access. Community members have urged expanding library space at the Cortelyou branch and adding outdoor space at the Flatbush branch.

Needs for Community Boards

CB 14 staff address thousands of service delivery requests annually. We organize an annual youth conference and nonprofit roundtable. Increasing responsibilities have been assigned and hiring staff and specialists, such as planners, policy analysts, IT assistance, would help to assess local impacts of citywide proposals, introduce more initiatives and develop longer range projects. Ultimately, we could better complement a complaint driven role with more proactive, grass roots plans. Technology and consultant needs, as we shift out of virtual-only meetings is a significant expense. Rules as well and the Board's wish to expand language access is hampered by city support and budgetary constraints. As the most local city agency, we give voice to the individuals who make up our communities. Every city agency has had a budget expansion over the last decade. Community Boards have not had one in over 20 years. Continued agency headcount and other capacity issues as well as poor inter and intra agency coordination make it harder for city agencies to reach the most local levels and communities are all the more frustrated. We are their liaison and our role more important than ever.

PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
BPL	1 / 2	Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library
BPL	2 / 2	Cortelyou Branch expansion
DPR	1 / 3	New public parks
DPR	2 / 3	Other capital budget request for DPR
DPR	3 / 3	Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)
DPR	CS	Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)
DPR	CS	Develop the Shirley Chisholm Welcome Center at Prospect Park

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
BPL	1 / 1	Extend library hours or expand and enhance library programs
DPR	1 / 3	Forestry services, including street tree maintenance
DPR	2 / 3	Plant new street trees
DPR	3 / 3	Community Tree Pruning
OMB	1 / 2	Provide more community board staff

6. OTHER BUDGET REQUESTS

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DCP	1 / 1	Process

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DCP	1 / 1	Process
DCWP	1 / 1	Other expense budget request for DCA
OMB	2 / 2	Other expense request

7. SUMMARY OF PRIORITIZED BUDGET REQUESTS

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

1 of 19 **Evaluate a public location or property for green infrastructure, e.g. rain gardens, stormwater greenstreets, green playgrounds**

DEP

Evaluate a public location or property for green infrastructure, e.g. rain gardens, stormwater greenstreets, green playgrounds

There are several locations in the district that flood chronically in rainstorms. These locations have all been brought to DEP's attention. It is difficult to identify what and where specifically capital projects are needed. They were apparently needed in the several locations where DEP had to make emergency repairs. We ask DEP to respond to the requests pending and ADVISE as to where upgrades and repairs are needed. During City of Yes for housing public hearing testimony, several community members and their council representatives decried flooding issues throughout the city. What does it say about DEP's capacity and coordination abilities that this was such a widespread concern and that it had to be expressed at a zoning hearing? Where is the DEP platform proactively upgrading infrastructure before we get to emergency repairs? There have been five recent emergency sewer repair jobs in the district just in the past months. These emergencies take months to fix and rely on other agencies and utilities for timely coordination. Furthermore, since they are "emergency" projects there is no Community Liaison assigned to keep the neighbors apprised. If this isn't indicative of the need for proactive maintenance, what is? DEP must provide solutions because property, businesses and public areas should not have to withstand chronic flooding. What capital projects would help in these various locations: bioswales, catch basins, permeable surface additions, holding tanks?

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

1 of 19 **More affordable housing for low and extremely low income households**

HPD

Provide more housing for extremely low and low income households

In HPD's own Mayor's Management Report, it was stated in the capital budget section that, "HPD must work to restore lost affordable housing capacity." Affordable housing is dropping as a share of housing in CD 14. Low and extremely low-income housing is always the smallest percentage of new developments, and they tend to be smaller units such as studios and 1 bedroom, making low-income housing for families nearly nonexistent. There are also pressing needs for senior housing and supportive housing in the community. HPD reported a \$9.25 billion 5-year capital fund but no additional capital was budgeted at the time due to headcount constraints prohibiting projects from moving forward. This must be remedied to ensure that the \$250 million infrastructure funds to support housing and training technology, new supportive housing builds, capital preservation, and In Rem capital projects can be funded to meet community needs. In CB14 there are 800 housing code violations for every 1000 units. HPD must improve capacity and coordinate within and with other agencies to meet this urgent need.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. HPD finances and supports different types of projects. Many projects are 100% affordable, and a portion of those units are ELI/VLI. Some projects contain a majority of ELI/VLI units. While HPD is breaking affordable housing production records, there is more work to be done. HPD will continue to maximize the use of subsidy and Low Income Housing Tax Credits (LIHTC) to projects in our development pipeline throughout the Five Boroughs, including those serving Very Low Income (VLI) and Extremely Low Income (ELI) populations.

1 of 19 Rehabilitate bridges

Rehabilitate bridges

DOT

The Beverley Road bridge and the Caton Road bridge both require rehabilitation. The Newkirk Avenue Road bridge is also in need of repair but due to purview complications related to Newkirk Plaza, DOT cannot add the bridge to a component contract, which will delay repairs.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. These are multiple items in one request so it was difficult to select the correct response category. Preliminary design on the Beverley Road Bridge is concluding. Final design work is scheduled to begin in 2026 Caton is not in the current 4 Year capital program. The city continues to investigate Newkirk and Foster for a future capital program.

1 of 19 Provide a new or expand an existing elementary school

Provide a new or expand an existing elementary school

SCA

DOE still acknowledges CD 14 as a district in need of seats. When last measured at full capacity, PS 139 was at 121% of utilization; PS 127 was 125%; PS 249 was at 128%, PS 193 at 111%; PS 315 was at 118% and the PS 152 Annex was at 146%. Since annexes are built to address overcrowding, an overcrowded annex boldly underscores the need for additional elementary school seats in the northern end of the District. The elementary schools listed above are all north of Avenue L. DOE and SCA need to provide a new needs assessment based on population changes and class size mandates. SCA no longer has the capacity to show up to CB Committee meetings to engage with community members and provide updates on ongoing capital projects or discuss building needs. Therefore it is difficult to provide specifics here.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. More information is needed from the community board before making a funding decision. The community board should contact the agency.

1 of 19 Repair or upgrade subway stations or other transit infrastructure

Repair or upgrade subway stations or other transit infrastructure

NYCTA

Location: Church Ave and E 18 St
Church Avenue is the most heavily utilized station in the district and is in disrepair. A public private partnership is in place to install an elevator to make the station ADA compliant. Other upgrades and additional security cameras must accompany this project, especially given that this will be more heavily utilized by vulnerable community members.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

1 of 19 Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses

Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses

NYPD

While NYPD continues the search for an appropriate location for a new precinct house, the current precinct house floods and leaks and does not have adequate lockers, storage, parking, nor is it handicap accessible. We have hesitated to prioritize capital dollars for a precinct house that should be replaced but as conditions worsen, there's a more urgent concern. There should not be a need for volunteer community assistance to maintain a precinct house. Work orders should be addressed quickly but at this point, many work orders are putting band aids on hemorrhages. NYPD should offer to buyout and help relocate Adapt Community Network in order to build on the block. In addition, the vacant lot on the block should be explored as a potential parking facility for the 70th Precinct.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. NYPD's capital plan doesn't include funding for a replacement precinct stationhouse. New funding to cover all associated costs are needed before this project can move forward.

1 of 19 Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library**BPL**

Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library

Ensure that all capital improvements are needed at our local libraries: Cortelyou Branch; Flatbush Branch; Midwood Branch; and Kensington Branch are met.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Brooklyn Public Library supports this request and has identified unfunded capital improvements at these locations.

1 of 19 Rehabilitate or renovate existing fire houses or EMS stations**FDNY**

Rehabilitate or renovate existing fire houses or EMS stations

Fund station house renovations and upgrades at Engine 255/Ladder 157; Engine 281/Ladder 147 and Engine 250 firehouses. Including the addition of a station house generator at one of these fire stations. There are no firehouses in CD 14 with a generator.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FDNY will seek to accommodate within existing resources, although this will depend on availability of funding and overall agency prioritization. The Community Board should continue work with their relevant elected officials to allocate Council/BP capital funding at Budget Adoption.

1 of 19 Process**DCP**

Other capital request for DCP

Please note that the following needs are in the order of the District Needs Statement narrative. Health and Human Services are first; followed by Youth, Education and Children's Services; Public Safety and Emergency Response; Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency; Housing, Land Use and Economic Development; Transportation; Parks and then Other. DCP's process requires CBs to list community needs in a misleading priority order. It has been stated in the District Needs Statement that we believe that needs are intertwined within and across agencies and do not believe it serves a purpose to have needs for parks to face off against needs for libraries (for example). What all agencies need at this time is an increase in their respective and collective capacity and ability to coordinate better within and with other sister city agencies. That's priority one across the board.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. This request was addressed this year. Following extensive consultation with community board partners, the prioritization of community board budget requests was updated in the district needs submission platform for the FY2027 submission cycle to categorize requests by agency, rather than requiring discrete lists of rank-ordered requests across all agencies. DCP is appreciative of Brooklyn CB 14 and others who similarly voiced interest in moving away from the prior priority system.

1 of 19 New public parks**DPR**

Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

CD14 is about the lowest ranking community board citywide for access to public green space. There are few locations to develop parks but they should be explored. A CB14 Fund for the City of New York Planning Fellow, made recommendations in 2017, some of which are no longer viable. The agency response to this is to ask local elected officials, which raises the overall concern about agency capacity and coordination. DPR should have a capital budget capacity that is adequate to meet capital needs based on objective community assessments rather than the vagaries of overlapping, term-limited political borders.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We support the request to acquire and develop new parkland within Community Board 14 but do not have capital funding available.

2 of 19 Other capital budget request for DPR**DPR**

Other capital budget request for DPR

The Lakeshore project is a multi-million-dollar green infrastructure project that would create marshland, utilize storm water for the benefit of the park and mitigate damaging flood conditions that affect homes, businesses, and other city assets such as the Parade Ground, the SRG Precinct, bus stops and more. It is a project that would increase access to the parks for mobility limited individuals. Funding this project addresses several capacity and coordination goals. Last year the agency responded that this project is funded. That is not so. This is at least a \$20 million project and in FY 25, \$5million was allocated to the second phase. This project must be fully funded, supported and expedited.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. We have \$20 million of funding in place for the Lakeshore Restoration Project and expect phase 1 of construction to be completed in 2028. For more information, please visit: <https://www.prospectpark.org/learn-more/what-we-do/advancing-the-park/capital-projects-tracker/> We support the request for additional funding for further phases of restoration.

2 of 19 Roadway maintenance (resurfacing, trench restoration, etc.)**DOT**

Roadway maintenance (resurfacing, trench restoration, etc.)

Six years ago, DOT identified \$60 million for trench repair but none of it was allocated to CD14, despite worsening conditions. We have been told that this funding was never applied to a repair and there is no funding for trench restoration. There must be an increase in the budget for road and street infrastructure repair. Seven locations have been submitted to DOT. 564 East 29th Street; 1781 Ocean Avenue/SE corner of Avenue M; 715 Ocean Parkway Service Road; Waldorf Court between East 17 and Dead End; Hillel Place and Kenilworth Place intersection; 464-476 East 16th Street; and East 16th Street between Avenue H and the dead end. DOT addresses these complaints by filling in the depressions with asphalt. Bus pads at the East 18th and Church Avenue station are in disrepair. Delineators are constantly strewn in streets, intersections and sidewalks. The constant need for repair should raise questions about efficiency. Can't DOT do better?

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. Funding is not available. for this. Additionally, DOT is not planning on funding new projects solely based on trench restorations. We will be working on initiating state of good repair street reconstruction projects that include trench restorations.

2 of 19 Improve accessibility of transit infrastructure, by providing elevators, escalators, etc.**NYCTA**

Improve accessibility of transit infrastructure, by providing elevators, escalators, etc.

The 18th Avenue Stop on the Culver Line is on the same block as the United Cerebral Palsy complex. This stop was recently upgraded. It's unfortunate that accessibility was not one of the improvements.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

2 of 19 Low income, supportive and senior housing**HPD**

Provide more housing for extremely low and low income households

The need for senior housing, supportive housing and increasing low and extremely low income housing will likely see greater pressures depending on how City of Yes for housing passes. There are few mandates to create housing that generates less process and is dependent on support programs, such as vouchers. CB14 has lost housing at 30% AMI as a share of housing overall. There are very few public lots in CB14 but HPD must work creatively to identify potential sites for 100% affordable developments. There is one municipal parking lot, a DOE building on Avenue M and Ocean Avenue and our libraries are one and two story buildings. These sites should be explored and HPD should be able to explain the reasons if they are not feasible for truly affordable housing projects.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. HPD is happy to partner with other agencies that have public land to consider development projects to advance affordable housing. Our ability to consider these projects hinges on our partner agencies' willingness and capacity to transfer these sites for redevelopment. HPD advises CB14 to engage with the agencies that own the properties mentioned in this budget request on their future plans for the site. Through Executive Order 43 of 2024 (Prioritizing Housing Production and Accelerating the Production of Housing on City Sites) the City convened a task force to review all land under City ownership and evaluate for potential housing production. This work will continue through Executive Order 4 of 2026 (Leveraging City-Owned Land to Accelerate Housing, "LIFT") which will review City and other publicly-owned sites to assess and develop strategies for housing generation.

2 of 19 Cortelyou Branch expansion**BPL**

Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library

Consider a building rehabilitation and expansion of the Cortelyou Road branch to increase space and opportunities to expand programming. The fact that this branch is a one-story building with a deep set back, suggests that there is developable space. In fact, CB14 notes this location in a HPD request suggesting a coordinated exploration of this site for both a library rehab and co-located housing (the Brooklyn Heights library is an example of such mixed use development).

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Brooklyn Public Library supports this request; however, the Library does not have the resources to expand space at Cortelyou Library.

2 of 19 Capital investments in Towing capacity**NYPD**

Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests

Every day there is a community request to have a vehicle towed. There are also trucks and trailers-some attached, some not. When they have plates or a later model and/or luxury vehicles and can only be towed by NYPD, it can take several weeks and more. PD notes that there is a shortage of large tow vehicles. Last year they asked CBs to request a new tow pound and then responded that they did not support the request. We strongly urge capital expenditures to increase the number of large tow vehicles and identify an additional tow pound as needed.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Additional NYPD resources for this project are unavailable at this time due to funding constraints. However, the program will continue to operate within current funding levels.

3 of 19 Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses**NYPD**

Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses

The time is now. The history of efforts to relocate this aging facility goes back three decades. In 2006, DCAS began property acquisition at 1326 Ocean Avenue and NYPD set aside \$30 million for the property, and OMB stated its commitment to identify additional funding. Construction was set to begin in 2013. It did not and the site was lost to a market rate housing development. A \$1 million scoping study to assess the feasibility of building a new precinct house on site acknowledges the locational challenges that the current site presents. OMB approved a site search to no avail. Relocating the precinct house remains a priority. NYPD must shift pressure on OMB into high gear for the sake of the MOS at the precinct level. No more shrugging as they pass the buck. Take responsibility.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Additional NYPD resources for this project are unavailable at this time due to funding constraints. However, the program will continue to operate within current funding levels.

3 of 19 Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)**DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

The Hot Spot Tot Lot on Campus Road is the only DPR asset that has not had a capital upgrade in over a decade. DPR should have greater control of capital purse strings to maintain parks and playgrounds in communities according to conditions and time between upgrades rather than relying on elected officials for capital funds. Usually those making the allocations will be term limited before the ribbon cutting. Please don't reply, "ask your elected officials." At least provide the scope estimate and support for this request.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We support the request to improve Hot Spot Tot Lot but do not have capital funding available. Please contact the Brooklyn Parks Commissioner's Office to discuss cost estimates for improvements to the playground.

3 of 19 Other transportation infrastructure requests**DOT**

Other transportation infrastructure requests

Ensure that sidewalks, curbs, street and bus pads are maintained at all bus stops. The bus stop at Church Avenue and East 18th street, which is a heavily utilized connection to the Brighton Line at the Church Avenue station is hazardous in both directions. The sidewalks require repair, the curbs are dilapidated and the streets have waving and pot holes. DOT installed an express lane on this stop and should have ensured bus pad, sidewalk and street maintenance along each stop during that project.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. This location was resurfaced in Summer 2025. Please let us know if there are further issues.

CS Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)**DPR**

Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

Location: Bedford Avenue - Church Avenue
The Flatbush African Burial Ground will be constructed as a memorial through the Department of Parks and Recreation. We understand that capital funding is in place. This is a continued support request assuming capital is adequate as told. CB14 highly prioritizes funding that is adequate to fully realize a vision of this important, sacred and historic site that is informed by community engagement with priority on the descendent community. We will also support expense funded to maintain and program if/as appropriate.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. We have \$4 million of funding in place for improvements to the Flatbush African Burial Ground and the design for the space. We hosted a community input meeting to inform the design in 2023 and Council Member Joseph hosted several subsequent public input meetings through 2024. The design has been approved by the Public Design Commission and we expect construction to begin in 2027. For more information, please visit: <https://www.nycgovparks.org/planning-and-building/capital-project-tracker/project/10496>

CS Develop the Shirley Chisholm Welcome Center at Prospect Park**DPR**

Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

A monument to community and national shero Shriley Chisholm is to be installed at the Ocean Avenue-Parkside entrance to Prospect Park. A full welcome center, with historic and memorial installation and a comfort station has been envisioned as well. This project should be funded. DPR should have its own capital budget to support such community investments. Instead, we anticipate the reply that the community should seek funding from Council. This is a DPR request but there should be a mechanism to choose DPR and DCLA since it is also cultural in nature.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. We have \$6.75 million of funding in place for the construction of the new Shirley Chisholm Pavilion and \$1 million of funding in place for a new Shirley Chisholm monument to be installed at the Parkside and Ocean Avenue entrance to Prospect Park. We expect construction of the pavilion to be completed in 2028 and erection of the monument to be completed in 2026. For more information, please visit:
<https://www.prospectpark.org/learn-more/what-we-do/advancing-the-park/capital-projects-tracker/>*

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS**1 of 38 Other expense budget request for DOT****DOT**

Other expense budget request for DOT

New York City must recognize ownership of the Plaza. The clearest solution we see is for Newkirk Plaza to become a formal participant in the DOT's Pedestrian Plaza Program. The City's inability to determine jurisdiction over Newkirk Plaza has left several chronic issues unresolved, including a serious rodent infestation, sanitation maintenance concerns, disrepair of the brick plaza surface, and growing street homelessness challenges. The New York City Police Department, the Department of Sanitation, the Department of Buildings, and the Department of Health and Mental Hygiene, have all been called upon to deal with myriad issues on the Plaza. Many community stakeholders, including business owners, civic and community-based organizations, and local government entities, continue to struggle

Agency Response: Agency does not support but can address the need alternatively. DOT is continuing to engage the MTA on this and will share updates as we have them.

1 of 38 Provide more housing for extremely low and low income households**HPD**

Provide more housing for extremely low and low income households

Ensuring that there is affordable housing for CD14's community members at lower strata of the AMI, for seniors and those in need of supportive housing rely on HPD fully implementing Housing Our Neighbors and all components of the Housing Blueprint plan including fighting tenant harassment. These programs seem to be falling short. Our community is left vulnerable to HPD's inability to increase agency headcount and thus capacity. Interagency coordination should be put into place such that DOB will not issue permits in buildings with HPD violations unless needed to address those very violations.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. HPD's total headcount has increased by by 3.7% from December 2020 to December 2024. While certain divisions were impacted due to staffing shortages at the start of the pandemic, we are continuing to provide services to all New Yorkers and have worked hard to increase our headcount. We continue to protect tenants through our Code Enforcement and Housing Litigation teams; and have had record breaking years in affordable housing construction/preservation. We would be open to further discussions and recommendations (as well specific cases) where DOB coordination can be further improved.

1 of 38 Forestry services, including street tree maintenance**DPR**

Forestry services, including street tree maintenance

Flatbush and Midwood boast 11,237 street trees, including 121 different species according to DPR's census. Argyle Road is considered the "leafiest" in Brooklyn. A more robust pruning cycle is still necessary. Requests for emergency pruning and fallen branches are increasing in the District. Fallen limbs, branches and entire trees too often were reported for pruning but not addressed. Paying claims instead of service is poor policy. DPR needs a better funded and more robust contracting practice in addition to an increase in the budget to bring the work in house.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. Funding for our block pruning program was restored to pre-COVID levels, and our 7-year pruning cycle matches industry standards. Any individual trees that need attention for public safety reasons should be reported by locating the tree on the NYC Tree Map (and clicking on the "report a problem" tab), calling 311, or using our online tree service request system. Our inspectors will visit the tree and determine the appropriate action in accordance with our Tree Risk Management Program. We agree with the need to increase staff and capacity to address our existing backlog of tree work. NYC Parks has made strides to increase its in-house tree work capacity through the Climber & Pruner Training Program, an in-house training program that connects current entry-level Parks employees with the training to become Climber & Pruners. With this program, Parks expects to add 15-20 new Climber & Pruners to the workforce every 15 months to help mitigate recruitment and hiring challenges.

1 of 38 Create or promote programs to de-stigmatize mental health needs and encourage treatment**DOHMH**

Create or promote programs to de-stigmatize mental health needs and encourage treatment

Nearly one in 25 New Yorkers has experienced mental illness. About 280,000 have major disorders such as schizophrenia. Forty percent of those in city shelters and 53% of those in city jails experience mental illness. From March to December of 2020, more than 17,000 calls were made for mental health assistance. This was 85 times more than the same period in 2019. The city must continue to expand mobile crises teams, and intensive mobile teams as well as HOMESTAT outreach to unsheltered homeless individuals experiencing mental illness. A Support and Connection Center should be provided in Brooklyn.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DOHMH defers to the Mayor's Office of Operations and Department of Social Services on HomeStat. We are happy to continue the dialogue on mobile crisis engagement as well as support and connections center

1 of 38 Other cleaning requests**DSNY**

Other cleaning requests

Please restore MLP in the baseline budget. There are 5 overlapping council members in CD14. Those overlaps vary in size and the council members vary in their willingness to give council member allocations back to city agencies, and that's understandable. These funds are supposed to supplement, not supplant agency responsibility. There are 1200 road segments in CD 14. Given the number of dead ends, overpasses, and road bridges, cleaning is a persistent need. The evisceration of MLP was ill advised. Asking council members to refund DSNY with Clean NYC or reso funds does not ensure equal distribution of services across the district and is financially inefficient. Baseline services should come from the baseline budget. Restore full funding for MLP so the district can be cleaned efficiently and equitably.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DSNY is not currently funded for additional MLP trucks.

1 of 38 Improve safety at homeless shelters**DHS**

Improve safety at homeless shelters

The men's shelter that opened in CD14 in 2023 has created a number of community concerns. Security, including perimeter patrols are not addressing the complaint that individuals are entering private property, defecating in the street, engaging in substance use. Interactions between shelter residents and residents of the adjacent supportive housing facility have not been positive for the clients or the community. The Community Advisory Board has not reassured residents. The impacts of this shelter are far worse than anticipated and funding to ensure adequate support, programing and safety is urgently needed. There is now another men's shelter in the district and the contract is held by a Staten Island organization with no track record running such a shelter. There was only a four day notification and no word on when the shelter will be at full census. There is reasonable concern that the clients within are not being well-served. There is very little reason to be confident that the city is awarding performance and merit-based contracts. Homelessness has been a crises for a long time. The shelter system seems to be in a crises of its own. The women's shelter in the district has not held a CAB meeting in over a year. This is supposed to be a contracted obligation.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. This request requires further investigation. Contact the agency Office of Intergovernmental Affairs to provide specific details so that we can look into these matters. We are happy to help facilitate reestablishing a CAB.

1 of 38 Clean catch basins**DEP**

Clean catch basins

There are several locations in the district that flood chronically that have all been brought to DEP's attention. It seems that the issues can only be resolved with capital investments and that is the second highest request on CB14 capital list. In the meantime, catch basin cleaning and maintenance, courtesy flushes, rain barrels, backflow valve education, and other short term mitigation strategies are needed.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

1 of 38 Provide more community board staff**OMB**

Provide more community board staff

Every year we manage hundreds of service delivery requests, a youth conference, a nonprofit roundtable. We've added a lunch and learn series, and a YLC. Increasing responsibilities have been assigned and hiring staff and specialists, such as planners, policy analysts, IT assistance, would help to introduce more initiatives and develop longer range projects. As the most local city agency, we give voice to the individuals who make up our communities. To support serving communities equitably, it is imperative that the city fund and provide language access services at the CB level.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. As of the FY 2027 Preliminary Budget, each Community Board's budget is being maintained.

1 of 38 Other expense budget request for DCA**DCWP**

Other expense request for DCWP

DCWP is the licensing and main enforcement agency for the sale of tobacco and e-cigarettes. The pace of inspections is slow, and the enforcement mechanisms is inadequate. More stores sell these items without a license than with one. Report of sales to minors and sales of flavored vapes are prevalent. A significant investment must be made in adding and training inspectors. At the state level, OCM is stepping into cannabis enforcement. The Sheriff's office has had impact on some enforcement. NYPD has been marginalized but remains involved where possible. This is an inefficient and ineffective approach.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Agency supports but cannot accommodate.

1 of 38 Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing

HRA

Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing

Community District 14 ranks high in the percentage of severely rent burdened households, which is to say that they pay 50% or more of their monthly income on housing. Overall, 29% of households are severely rent burdened. This is down from a recent high of 35%. For low-income households, 44% are severely rent burdened. The share of units available at 30% AMI has decreased again. When we say that we need affordable housing, not just housing, this is the basis. The District ranks 3rd in Brooklyn and is in the top 10 citywide in the percent of renter households that are severely overcrowded. These are pressures that lend themselves to homelessness and continued expansion of prevention programs is warranted. Emergency rental assistance, one-shot deals, FEPS, CityFEPs, and the HOMEBASE program must be fully funded and the capacity of HRA to provide outreach and technical assistance must be increased. Greater coordination between programs such as WeCare to address housing vulnerabilities related to mental health needs and further support for those transition into permanent housing are needed as well.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. The administration has moved a record number of people out of shelter and has preserved affordable units for tens of thousands of New Yorkers.

1 of 38 Other foster care and child welfare requests

ACS

Other foster care and child welfare requests

When asked by survey to rank public safety priorities, 85% of respondents ranked support for cure violence groups, number one. ACS's Division of Youth and Family Justice and the efforts to support violence disrupters programs and organizations is a high priority from a youth service and a public safety perspective. There are several programs that ACS has introduced or grown in recent years. CD14 organizations have applied to the RFP for Family Enrichment Program. We hope they will be awarded. As for foster care and casework, the agency has made positive strides in reducing caseloads and fostered youth is at an all-time low.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Thank you for your interest in our work. We are in the final stages of expanding from 3 to 30 Family Enrichment Centers. This past year, we invested \$1623 million in the youth safety and success initiative, for you youth in and transitioning out of foster care and services to help prevent justice involvement. This initiative expands 4 programs and creates one new one: Fair Futures: This first-of-its-kind program already serves more than 4,000 young people by connecting youth in foster care and the juvenile justice system between the ages of 11-26 with tutoring and coaching to build life skills, set academic and career goals and more. This investment will allow an additional 2,000 youth to be served. College Choice: Established in 2022, this program offers college tuition, room and board assistance, individualized support and stipends for young people in foster care. The program had more than 400 students in the fall of 2024 and with this funding can serve over 500 students. Career Choice/Workforce Ready: This new program builds off the success of College Choice and connects young people in foster care who do not go to a two or four-year college but are participating in vocational and job readiness training with financial and social support as vocational and job readiness training. This funding will also allow for an expansion to DYCD's Advance and Earn program. (40 slots which equate to 80 youth via expansion of DYCD's Advance and Earn Program & 232 stipends for eligible youth) • Girls JustUs: A highly-successful gender-responsive juvenile justice diversion program that currently operates in Brooklyn will now be expanded to Queens and the Bronx. (24 additional girls will be served via this expansion) • Assertive Community Engagement and Success (ACES): A program that provides evidence-based services to high-risk youth who have been involved with the justice system. The program provides social pathways away from gang and gun violence to young people between the ages of 16-24. This program beginning in FY 27, will now be expanded city wide and will allow over 400 more young people to take part each year.

1 of 38 Address illegal conversions and uses of buildings

DOB

Address illegal conversions and uses of buildings

There is need for more DOB action on illegal conversions in what would be single family homes and in multifamily buildings. Enforcement on illegal curb cuts and parking pads would move the city toward carbon neutrality. Rather than using the tools we have, there is a new zoning text amendment. Short term rentals are not enforced. Some air bnbs have been reported in the already scarce affordable units in the district.

Agency Response: The agency does not understand the request as written and requires more clarification. Airbnb is under the jurisdiction Mayor's Office of Special Enforcement.

1 of 38 Provide, expand, or enhance the Summer Youth Employment Program**DYCD**

Provide, expand, or enhance the Summer Youth Employment Program

According to our Youth Conference attendees survey, the biggest draw for the 500 youth who attended our annual conference was jobs. It is imperative that DYCD jobs programs be expanded and dependably funded. Additional focus on building capacity at the CBO level to expand programming into underserved communities is imperative. Cure violence programs depend on significant alternatives. DYCD is poised to support new models of curing violence and expanding opportunities for future leaders. All DYCD programs should include a component on fraud prevention and financial literacy.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Each summer, NYC supports 100,000 youth jobs through the Summer Youth Employment Program. The required curriculum includes financial literacy.

1 of 38 Hire additional crossing guards**NYPD**

Hire additional crossing guards

Additional crossing guards is an ever increasing request. New schools have opened, new developments are in the pipeline. The Community Board defers to the Police Precinct to assign additional crossing guards to new locations. It is our understanding that these positions are difficult to fill. Therefore, we request that the city demonstrate that it cares about student safety by either increasing pay to meet the labor pool or by posting NYPD or Traffic officers to augment the crossing guard labor pool as it stands. Funding should also cover substitute crossing guards so that intersections are not without this important safety measure when a crossing guard is out for any period of time. In the past NYPD would fill a vacant position with a police officer until the crossing guard returned or the spot was filled. This practice should be reinstituted.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Based on the latest budget, the NYPD has a specific budgeted headcount. The agency is working on filling vacancies in order to get to that headcount.

1 of 38 Increase staffing for homebound adult programs**DFTA**

Increase staffing for homebound adult programs

Case management, home care, legal services, and transportation services are generally intertwined. There is no way to prioritize the needs of one senior citizen over those of another and it would be folly to provide transportation over home care for a senior who is in need of both. The funding of these services must be designed with the approach that support services are inextricable.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Need another funding to meet this need.

1 of 38 Extend library hours or expand and enhance library programs**BPL**

Extend library hours or expand and enhance library programs

The Community Board supports the continuation and expansion of programs that are so valuable in connecting our community members to literacy and culture. From small children, to teens, adults and older adults, the breadth of library programming is impressive and invaluable. We are grateful that branch managers and program directors are so active with the board and always willing to share and update us regarding new programs and services.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Brooklyn Public Library supports increased operational funding to equitably expand branch hours, programming, resources, and collections.

1 of 38 Provide more firefighters or EMS workers**FDNY**

Provide more firefighters or EMS workers

Fund adequate new firefighter, Marshall, EMS and inspector hires. Given the pace of development and the density that is adding to our community, it is imperative that we ensure that staffing remain optimal and that the addition of a 5th firefight on the truck is expanded to firehouses serving our community. The number of firefighters fully trained for all inspections should be at 100%.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. FDNY assesses operational needs on a regular basis and will accommodate as best able within existing budget.

1 of 38 Provide commercial lease support for business owners**SBS**

Provide commercial lease support for business owners

Supporting venues that generate social capital and drive economic development is key to post pandemic recovery. Kings Theater was an EDC project that is owned and managed by a private entity and is a for profit enterprise. The city then enacted several policy decisions in the area that undermined the original multi-million-dollar investment in the theater as an economic driver.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. NOT SBS - This is for EDC.

1 of 38 Process**DCP**

Other expense request for DCP

Please note that the following needs are in the order of the District Needs Statement narrative. Health and Human Services are first; followed by Youth, Education and Children's Services; Public Safety and Emergency Response; Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency; Housing, Land Use and Economic Development; Transportation; Parks and then Other. DCP's process requires CBs to list community needs in a misleading priority order. It has been stated in the District Needs Statement that we believe that needs are intertwined within and across agencies and do not believe it serves a purpose to have needs for parks to face off against needs for libraries (for example). What all agencies need at this time is an increase in their respective and collective capacity and ability to coordinate better within and with other sister city agencies. That's priority one across the board.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. This request was addressed this year. Following extensive consultation with community board partners, the prioritization of community board budget requests was updated in the district needs submission platform for the FY2027 submission cycle to categorize requests by agency, rather than requiring discrete lists of rank-ordered requests across all agencies. DCP is appreciative of Brooklyn CB 14 and others who similarly voiced interest in moving away from the prior priority system.

1 of 38 Maternal Health Disparities**HHC**

Other expense budget request for HHC

Develop programs and outreach to address maternal health care disparities through community outreach and medical care services.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The system has made key investments to support maternal health care in Brooklyn and throughout the City. This includes our Maternal Medical Home operating investments along major capital improvements supported by the Brooklyn Borough President.

1 of 38 Address overcrowded buses**NYCTA**

Expand bus service frequency or hours of operation

Assess use of busses and add to routes, especially morning commutes.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

2 of 38 Expand street outreach**DHS**

Expand street outreach

Over the years, we have been told by the Department of Homeless Services that it takes an average of 250 encounters with unsheltered individuals to convince them to accept services. This suggests that services offered are not in line with the needs of those living unsheltered. More robust teams with specialized services including those to address addictions, and mental health issues must augment street outreach. Innovative approaches such as the SHAP program must be expanded in Brooklyn. This program recruits volunteers, many of whom are formally "street homeless" persons and thus, more often trusted messengers for street outreach and their success rate is outstanding. In their second year, of 454 encounters, they placed 226 individuals. The increased capacity afforded to Breaking Ground last year should be coordinated with innovative outreach strategies that are already out there! For those on the street, mobile hygiene and health services should be expanded both for the immediate needs of unsheltered people and for the investment in building trust these services promote.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DHS collaborates closely with other City Agencies, local community-based organizations (CBOs), and our non-profit contracted providers to develop innovative strategies and strengthen effective existing services. While identifying and expanding best practices is a key goal, it is equally essential to recognize the importance of building trust with unsheltered clients. Given the potential traumas they may have experienced, establishing these relationships often requires considerable time and patience.

2 of 38 Provide, expand, or enhance programs for housing inspections to correct code violations**HPD**

Provide, expand, or enhance programs for housing inspections to correct code violations

CD14 has one of the highest serious housing code violations per 1000 units of housing in the city and it is getting worse. HPD must be granted enforcement authority that makes a difference. Inspector training and technology, fully implementing Housing Our Neighbors and all components of the Housing Blueprint plan and fighting tenant harassment are all programs that seem to be falling short. Our community is left vulnerable to HPD's inability to increase agency capacity. Interagency coordination should be put into place such that DOB will not issue permits in buildings with HPD violations unless needed to address those very violations.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. This is a priority for the administration and HPD and we will continue to work with key stakeholders to ensure poor housing conditions in NYC are properly enforced. The issue of DOB permits being denied based on HPD violations is already covered by legislation in some cases.

2 of 38 Address traffic congestion**DOT**

Address traffic congestion

The need to address freight mobility, including trucking, waterways, light rail and last mile trucking concerns are increasingly urgent. A review of truck routes is a task that DOT has started and stopped over the years. In CD 14 Caton Avenue to Linden Blvd is a truck route. Just south of Caton is Church Avenue - also a truck route. Traffic is gridlocked on Caton nearly endlessly in both directions. There is an express bus lane has been added to Church Avenue, eliminating truck delivery windows. These conditions have pushed more traffic onto sidestreets. The proliferation of 53' trucks on our streets is dangerous testament to the city's inability to coordinate interagency issues. We have turned to DOT, NYPD, and NYS DOT for relief, to no avail.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. This is not a budget request. Please reach out to our office to discuss further.

2 of 38 Create or promote programs to de-stigmatize substance misuse and encourage treatment**DOHMH**

Create or promote programs to de-stigmatize substance misuse and encourage treatment

Street outreach teams, NYPD, and human services organizations report that many people who appear to be unsheltered often have homes but congregate where they can access and use substances. There are few programs available to them unless they are in fact homeless or choose to seek care. This is a woeful and dangerous approach, or lack thereof. Community Mobile and Intensive Mobile teams should be expanded in Brooklyn.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Many City agencies offer helpful intervention services to both those that are housed or unhoused. Similar to other services, an individual must be willing to be engaged accept services from a mobile outreach team.

2 of 38 Assign additional building inspectors (including expanding training programs)**DOB**

Assign additional building inspectors (including expanding training programs)

DOB is operating with a 15% deficit in human resources. Many of these unfulfilled positions are inspectors. With the continued growing rate of new construction in the district, this is an urgent priority. Too many complaints are closed out due to lack of access while unpermitted work continues to the point of completion. Better timing of inspections, additional attempts and more detailed follow ups would assist in the ability to enforcement myriad violations.

Agency Response: Agency does not support but can address the need alternatively. The department continues to hire and train new staff with existing budget. Note, if complaints are closed due to lack of access, it means an inspector visited the site and access was not granted. There are several reasons access was not granted - no one present to grant access to the premises or property owner refuses to grant access either way the Inspector leaves a notice for property owner to call for an inspection. DOB Inspectors makes three attempts to inspect prior to closing out a complaint.

2 of 38 Increase enforcement of street vending**DSNY**

Increase enforcement of street vending

The addition of vendor enforcement has not been adequately resourced. There are not enough San Police and they don't cover specific areas. There is not a transparent reporting system in place. The problem has only exacerbated since shifting enforcement to DSNY. This is a failed policy and while it's in these budget priorities, it might not be a good idea to continue funding a failed policy. This one needs a paradigm shift that is balanced with fair permitting for vendors. That would take interagency coordination. As of now, we have chronic locations that are expanding and ironically creating litter and other sanitation issues.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DSNY is not currently funded for additional Sanitation Police Officers or Enforcement Agents.

2 of 38 Funding for a new senior center program**DFTA**

Funding for a new senior center program

Engage in reimagining an RFP for senior centers. The population of persons 65 years old and up in CD14 has increased from 10% in 2010 to 17% in 2021.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Need another funding to meet this need.

2 of 38 Plant new street trees**DPR**

Plant new street trees

There is a lack of enforcement when it comes to developers and planting requirements. Elected officials have used reso funds to plant trees where it was a developers responsibility. Where planting is the city's responsibility it should be properly funded and then adequately pruned.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. Under the NYC Zoning Resolution (Article II, Chapter 6), one street tree, pre-existing or newly planted, shall be provided for every 25 feet of street frontage of the zoning lot for all new developments or major alterations. Where Parks determines that such tree planting would be infeasible, trees may be planted at an off-site location provided by Parks. Planting requirements can be met via a payment to Parks' Tree Fund or via a planting permit. Note that zoning plantings are separate from and in addition to replacement or restitution obligations, all of which are the obligation of the developer.

2 of 38 Other expense request**OMB**

Other expense request

DCP and OMB - improve DNS and budget process.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. As of the FY 2027 Preliminary Budget, each Community Board's budget is being maintained.

2 of 38 Lifeguard training and management**FDNY**

Expand funding for fire prevention and life safety initiatives

The City should transfer the responsibility for lifeguard training and management from the Dept of Parks and Recreation to FDNY. These jobs are life safety initiatives and could provide a pathway to career emergency services. This is a proposal that was studied by IBO and is supported by some councilmembers. In addition, FDNY personnel should be able to "moonlight" as lifeguards. This was a practice in the past that the city paused for budgetary reasons. Fund the payroll to ensure public safety at city beaches.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. FDNY works closely with its public safety partners including NYPD and Parks to provide dedicated emergency response coverage at beaches during the beach season.

2 of 38 Newkirk Plaza**NYCTA**

Improve subway station or train cleanliness, safety and maintenance

It took years to convince DOT to accept Newkirk Plaza into the pedestrian plaza program. It took another year for DOT lawyers and MTA lawyers to compose an agreement. It has now taken another year for MTA to conduct the necessary engineering study prior to implementing the agreement. It's a slap in the face of the community that the MTA is simultaneously trying to engage in support of the IBX plan. Additionally, MTA would not let a local CBO improve the Newkirk Plaza station house with a mural because they claimed that station houses have to be identifiable as such. However, the station house is filthy and covered in graffiti - why would this be considered more identifiable. If MTA is not taking care of the assets currently in our community, why would they expect the community to welcome the new assets that come along with the IBX? They should expect a great deal of skepticism if not anger and dismay.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

3 of 38 Other programs to address public health issues requests**DOHMH**

Other programs to address public health issues requests

Public health programs that address health disparities with an urgent focus on maternal health are of the highest priorities. Ongoing infection disease concerns, barriers to vaccines whether they be knowledge and understanding based, cultural practices based, language access, etc. must be thoughtfully addressed. Access to quality housing, healthy food choices and outdoor space all contribute systemically to health outcomes and thus cannot be considered singularly, let alone in competition with one another.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DOHMH looks forward to discussing further ways we can partner with communities to address public health concerns including providing resources and materials for dissemination

3 of 38 Provide or expand NYC organics collection program**DSNY**

Provide or expand NYC organics collection program

Reinstate community compost sites to complement once-a-week curbside collection.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Funding for community composters was added in FY26.

3 of 38 Community Tree Pruning**DPR**

Forestry services, including street tree maintenance

While DPR struggles to build enough capacity to address tree pruning needs, there should be an effort to better coordinate the Community Tree Pruners program. Reportedly, residents who would like to become qualified to become tree pruners, cannot get into the program. If DPR doesn't have the capacity to accept help expanding capacity, that's a real problem!

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Trees New York (not NYC Parks) runs the Citizen Pruner program. Those interested must complete and pass Trees New York's Citizen Pruner Course. Visit their website (<https://treesny.org/>) or email info@treesny.org for more information.

4 of 38 Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations**DOHMH**

Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations

Rodent complaints have risen throughout the city, While DOHMH continues to increase the number of inspections performed annually, these efforts are outpaced by conditions contributing to rodent infestations. DOT's Open Streets for restaurant policy, DOB's abatement rules for construction sites should have better storage and collection policies. DSNY should be better equipped to address illegal drop offs and dumping. A better public education plan so that people understand the downside of feeding feral cats and birds is needed.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DOHMH is happy to discuss ways to partner on reducing rodent populations, including hosting Rat Academies for property owners and proper garbage disposal

4 of 38 Targeted enforcement**DSNY**

Increase enforcement of illegal dumping laws

The drop down menu on this report platform lists 10 "increase enforcement" options. This board is loathe to ask for more enforcement when DSNY demonstrates an inability to aim violations at the actual offender. DSNY is failing to enforce vendor rules but then penalizes brick and mortar businesses by serving violations for the litter that vendors left behind. DSNY has not restored MLP and then issues violations to homeowners who are victims of illegal drop offs. DSNY went on a ticket writing blitz and wrote tickets for early set out at 7:30 on Fridays in a Jewish Orthodox community. We don't want more enforcement, we want appropriately targeted enforcement. An increase in cameras at locations where chronic drop offs occur, is a good place to start. An increase in stakeouts, would be helpful. The ability to open bags and increase according to addressed contents within, might help as well. These approaches seem more likely to mitigate the behavior of offenders in a manner that is more targeted than gimmicky "hall of shame" photos that only show us where but not who.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. DSNY will try to accommodate this request using existing resources.

5 of 38 Commercial containers**DSNY**

Provide more on-street trash cans and recycling containers

DSNY should not expect BIDs to pay for containers. BIDs were created to supplement, not supplant city services. If DSNY is going to mandate containers, they should be provided in the same way corner baskets were provided. Please don't pass this responsibility off to elected officials either. This is DSNY's program and should be in DSNY's baseline budget.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. BIDs were provided funding to purchase containers as a part of the FY26 budget.